English methodology for pte

Diploma in teachers education (Vision Empowerment Training Institute)

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ENGLISH – METHODOLOGY

INTRODUCTION TO LANGUAGE LEARNING AND LANGUAGE TEACHING

Definition of Language

Language as a word is based on the Latin word *lingua* (tongue) meaning speech. However, in general terms it is defined as a system of arbitrary symbols used by human beings or animals for communication. Human language appears in two forms: written and spoken. As such, language used by human beings (spoken language / speech) is defined as a system of arbitrary vocal symbols used by human beings for communication.

Note that animals, too, communicate but they do not use spoken language (speech). They may use tail movements, feather movements, ear movements or even vocal sounds. As such, they may communicate to express anger, fear, warning or desire to do something like mating. The vocal sounds produced by animals, however, are described differently: barking for dogs, mooing for cows, bleating for sheep, braying for donkey, chattering for monkeys, neighing for horses etc.

Special Features / Characteristics of Human Language (Speech)

a. Arbitrariness
   It is abstract .i.e. there is no one on one relationship between form and meaning (thing being referred to). For example, something as big as a **whale** can be referred to by such a short word yet a small thing like a razorblade has such a long word. Similarly, a four-legged domestic canine can be referred to differently by different languages .i.e.:

ENGLISH	KISWAHILI	LUHYA	MERU	TAITA	KIKUYU
Dog	Mbwa	Imbwa	Ku`ru`		

b. Duality of patterning:
   The discrete parts of a language can be recombined in a systematic way to create new forms. For example: /a/, /p/, /e/, /t/, /n/ can be re-organized severally to form pan, pet, ten, tan etc. The words are also re-organized to form phrases, and phrases combined to form sentences.
c. Displacement
   It can be used to talk about things that are not within the immediate context of the speaker .i.e. both the past and the future can be talked about in the present. People can also talk of things that are physically far away, for instance other countries. Similarly, they can talk of things they have never seen like eternal fire in hell.
d. Productivity
   One is able to use language to create utterances never heard before.
e. Cultural transmission
   Although human beings are born with ability to communicate, they acquire language from other speakers within their reach.
f. Dynamism
   The transmission of language from one cultural generation to another keeps on changing .i.e. old words and expressions go out of use or change their meaning, while new words are introduced.

g. Semanticity

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Specific signals can be matched with specific meaning. For example: The English word, 'come' and the Luhya word, 'itsa' both mean that the listener moves from where she or he is and go where the speaker is. The speakers of both languages will associate the signal with the meaning intended.

h. Use of varied media
A similar message can be expressed in many different forms. It can either expressed in speech or written. It can be encoded in electronic media and transmitted over long distances. It can also be stored and retrieved when required.

Functions / Uses of Human Language

a. Establish relationships / Interaction
People use language to establish relationship with one another. It may be used to reflect and convey various degrees of friendship, hatred, respect, or politeness among members of a society. As such, people may use proper nouns to denote their family or occupation.
b. Expressing feelings, attitudes, and opinions.
It is used to express individual's or group's view point.
c. Conveying information, idea and experience
People use language to pass information, idea and experience from an individual to another or an individual to society. For instance: When a senior person in the country dies, written or spoken language is used to announce the death. It can also be used to talk about the past hence informing us about our history.
d. Instructing, requesting and directing
Here, language is used to regulate people's action and behavior. For example: A teacher instructing students to sit down or how to do an exercise. A person may use language to request for water when he or she is thirsty.
e. Social conventions
When language is used in this context, it cements relationships. Such social conventions include: greetings, sympathy, congratulations, sympathy, reprimands and condolences.
f. Creative expressions.
Writers and actors use language creatively to express themselves in drama, folklores, novels, debates, poetry, narratives and some songs to convey message in an aesthetic manner.

Varieties of Language

Accent

It deals with differences in pronunciation. David Cystle, "An accent is a particular way of speaking which tells the listener something about the speaker's background, for example, his region or country." We can tell the native speakers of a language by considering the accent, for example, we can detect French speakers when they are speaking English. However, differences in accent doesn't necessarily cause breakdown in communication though it might alter the meaning intended.

Dialect

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It refers to a variety of language with distinct vocabulary, grammar, lexical items and even pronunciation (accent). The term connotes with low status form of a language and its unwritten forms. A dialect is therefore smaller in size and prestige than a language. Based on this, we can therefore define language as a collection of mutually intelligible dialects.

Types of Dialects

a. Regional Dialect
   This results from geographical separations, for instance, rivers, lakes, mountains or forests.
b. Social Dialect / Sociolect
   This may be determined by class, profession, religion, gender, residence, level of income etc. For instance, in India, each caste speaks its variety of Hindu .i.e. Brahmin or Sutra
c. Idiolect
   This is a personal mannerism in the use of language .i.e. in grammar, vocabulary etc.

Register

This is language according to use. It may be defined by field of discourse (occupation, subject matter, profession), tenor of discourse and mode of discourse (medium). It is therefore a form of language appropriate to a particular area of human experience such as the legal profession, religion, politics, medicine, sport commentators, parliament, lecture etc. Register therefore is a variety of language whose choice is governed by situation, context or setting .i.e. a situational restricted use of language.

Variables which Govern the Choice of Register / Elements of Register

a. Social differences
   Where there is a marked social class system, like it used to be in the U.K. where we had the upper class, bourgeoisie and the lower class, there are likely to be differences in the use of language. This may also be linked to the speaker's level of education.

b. Tenor of Discourse .i.e. the relationship between the speaker and the listener.
   The use of language varies a great deal based on the level of relationship between the speaker and the listener. For instance, the way friends will talk to each other is different from the way strangers will talk to each other.

c. Mode of discourse / Medium of communication
   This is the degree of formality .i.e. the same person can use language with more or less care depending on the situation he is in. For instance: Conducting an interview (very formal) and same person chatting at home (very informal). It therefore determines whether the language will be standard or non-standard or the variation between formal and informal language. This variation also extends to the written language .i.e. in personal and official letters. Also, spoken language varies greatly with written language. Written language is done with a lot of care than spoken language .i.e. medium of communication.

d. Field of Discourse / Occupational differences

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The use of special forms or particularly vocabulary depending on what is being talked about or in specific fields such as computer programming, science, law or medicine can make the language difficult for the layman to understand. This is what gives rise to the so called **jargon**.

Diglossia

Ferguson (1959), defines it as, 'A situation where two varieties of a language exist side by side throughout the community, with each having a definite role to play." One of the varieties is considered 'formal' and is held to be high (H) and is used in such functions as sermons, lectures, political speeches, news broadcast, newspapers etc. It is usually accorded prestige and learnt in schools. The other variety is said to be low (L) and it is used in ordinary conversation, for instance, friends or some local radio stations. It is only acquired at home in an informal set up, for instance, from parents or peers. Diglossia is also defined as two languages which are assigned distinct functions, for instance, in India where Hindu is high (H) while Khalapun is lower (L).

BASIC LANGUAGE SKILLS

We have four basic language skills that are taught and developed in the following order in English:

1. Listening
   ↓
2. Speaking
   ↓
3. Reading
   ↓
4. Writing

The skills are further categorized into two as:

a. Receptive skill (the process of taking in information) .i.e. listening and reading.
b. Productive skill (the process of giving out information) .i.e. writing and speaking.

In language development, the receptive skills develop faster than the productive skills. Normally, children are able to understand more than they can speak, and they read better than they can write. The four skills should therefore be taught in a sequential and flexible manner in the process of teaching.

MOTHER TONGUE (MT OR L1) ACQUISITION AND SECOND LANGUAGE (L2) LEARNING AND DEVELOPMENT

Mother Tongue (MT or L1) Acquisition

Mother tongue is the first native language that a child learns before formal schooling. Basically, L1 equips the child with oral skills (listening and speaking).

Features of Mother Tongue (MT or L1) Acquisition / Factors that Contribute to Successful Learning of Mother Tongue

1. Prolonged and intensive exposure to the language
   Even before the child starts speaking, the infant is spoken to by the parents, relatives, house-help and any other people around. Gradually, the infant starts to associate those sounds with objects and situations. As the infant starts to speak, the exposure intensifies

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when it interacts with peers in playgrounds both at school and home. The media (television and radio) also contributes a lot to this exposure.

2. High motivation
   The language acts as an incentive once the children realizes that it can be used to express their feelings and needs from parents and siblings. Later, their need to interact with other people prompts them to develop a social language: they learn to greet and thank people when offered something.
3. Informality in acquisition / learning
   The language is picked up in a natural atmosphere .i.e. from parents, minders, peers and neighbours. We do not have a teacher, classroom or planned schedules during learning of the language. The child freely learns the language without frustration and correction of mistakes.
4. Imitation and experimentation with sounds
   The desire to imitate and experiment with sounds provides a platform for mother tongue learning. Children eventually learn to produce one word, two words and finally full sentences. These utterances are highly reinforced by encouragements and approval from mostly parents and siblings.

Second Language (L2) Learning and Development

Second language is any additional language (s) that a child learns after L1. In Kenya, mostly the L2 is English. In learning the L2, the new language items should be learnt first orally (listening and speaking), reading and writing respectively. Teachers of English should be role models by providing correct pronunciation, stress and intonation as learners imitate them.

Features of Second Language (L2) Learning and Development / Factors that Affect the Second Language (L2) Learning and Development

1. Limited exposure to language
   Compared to mother tongue, time of exposure to English in learning and practicing it is limited than mother tongue. In most rural area, especially in lower classes, English language is only exposed to learners during English language lesson. Even in upper primary the situation is virtually the same and only during general school activities.
2. Formality in learning
   The learning situation for the L2 is very formal: there is a trained teacher, a school set up, classroom situation, a defined syllabus presented in approved course books and a clear timetable to be followed. All these coupled sometimes with poor teaching methods and poor teacher role models who are not native speakers of the English language may seem unnatural to the learners.
3. Lack of motivation and reinforcement
   The child has little inner drive in learning English; sometimes there is little or no incentive to learn as it is not given the social value compared to mother tongue. The child doesn't use it to get what he or she wants most of the time thus considers it useless. Also, English is treated superficially hence no feeling of satisfaction or confidence in the learner.

Implication of Mother Tongue Acquisition for Second Language Learning

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In order to make the second language (English) learning as successful as the acquisition of mother tongue teachers of English should do the following:

a. Maximize pupil's exposure to the English language
   Use English routinely in classroom procedures like calling register, organizing learning activities, giving instructions or directions and encourage pupils to use it for interaction outside the classroom. Also encourage other teachers to use English in giving instructions apart from Kiswahili lessons.
b. Reduce formality in teaching and learning of English language
   - Provide a classroom learning atmosphere which is relaxed and stress-free.
   - Encourage cheerful and positive attitudes towards learning to allow participation of learners without intimidation. Encourage pupils to learn both from their peers and teachers.
   - Incorporate the learner's background knowledge and experience into the learning activities.
   - Provide the right model to the learners for them to gain appropriate vocabulary, language expressions and self confidence.
   - Have varied teaching techniques to cater for both fast and weak learners.
c. Increase motivation of learning the English language
   - Provide suitable rewards or reinforcement .e.g. verbal approval or commendations, clapping and encouraging cues.
   - Treat errors with understanding not as a sign of laziness or foolishness. Handle corrections with patience. Focus on the pupil's strength not weaknesses.
   - Use motivating support activities in language such as narratives, drama, poetry, language games and songs.
   - Use interesting, varied, relevant, suitable and attractive learning materials.
   - Emphasize on the important role of English in school and beyond.
d. Intensify practice of concepts learnt
   Emphasize on individual language practice rather than mass practice.

LANGUAGE POLICY IN KENYAN PRIMARY SCHOOLS

The Republic of Kenya has over forty-two linguistic groups. As such, the government through the ministry of Education has provided a legal framework which regulates the use of various languages (mother tongue –L1 as a fist language, English – L2 as second language and Kiswahili – L3 as the third language) in schools. These languages are either used as medium of instruction or just taught as a subject based on the policy provided by the Ministry of Education.

Languages Used as Medium of Instruction in Primary Schools:

Lower Primary (Class 1-3)

Here, the medium of instruction is the language of the catchment / local area .i.e. mother tongue – L1. In rural areas the language is usually first language of the learner but in mixed community area it is usually Kiswahili. The language of the catchment area is used to teach all other subjects and skills except other languages .e.g. English.

Reasons for this policy:

a. Transition from home to school is made easy for the children.

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b. Pupils find it easy to participate in the learning activities and can respond to instructions easily hence promoting teacher-pupil relationship.
c. Teaching becomes meaningful to pupils since the language used is familiar to them.

Upper Primary (Class 4-8)
Here, the medium of instruction is English.

Reasons for this policy:
a. It is used as a link between primary and secondary school education or tertiary institutions.
b. Most course books and reference materials in various subjects are written in English.
c. All subjects, except Kiswahili, are taught in English.
d. All examinations, except Kiswahili and other languages are written in English.
e. It enhances the teaching of English as a subject.

Languages Taught as Subjects
General Objectives of Teaching English as a Subject in Primary Schools
a. It is the official Language in Kenya.
b. It is an international language therefore used in international commerce.
c. Pupils can later on access written materials from other parts of the world.

Specific Objectives of Teaching Specific Languages in Lower Primary (Class 1-3)
a. English: To prepare learners since it is used as a medium of instruction in upper primary. The policy states, "*By the end of the first three years the learner should have acquired sufficient command of vocabulary and language patterns to enable them to use English in the upper primary.*"
b. Kiswahili: It is the national language in Kenya.
c. Mother tongue: As medium of instruction to enable learners acquire reading and writing competence in their own language. Also to help pupils learn and maintain their culture.

Specific Objectives of Teaching Specific Languages in Upper Primary (Class 4-8)
a. English:
- It is the official language.
- It is the medium of instruction in upper primary and also used to teach other subjects.
- It has potential value beyond school level.
- To improve and widen the pupil's language skills already acquired in lower primary.

The policy states, "*At the end of the primary course the learners should be able to communicate fluently, independently and accurately in their everyday life*".
b. Kiswahili: It is the national language hence the *lingua franca* in East and Central Africa.

General Objectives of Language Skills
a. **Listening:** Pupils should be able to listen, understand and respond appropriately when communicated to in English.

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b. **Speaking:** Pupils should be able to express themselves orally in English using correctly constructed sentences, appropriate vocabulary, intelligible pronunciation, stress and intonation.
c. **Reading:** Pupils should be able to:
    - Read silently, fluently and independently at a good speed
    - Read carefully for information gathering and comprehension.
    - Work out new language items through the use of phonic skills and contextual clues.
    - Read for pleasure.
    - Read and use reference materials such as dictionary and encyclopedia for purposes of study.
d. **Writing:** Pupils should be able to express themselves legibly in written English using appropriate punctuations, spelling, grammar and vocabulary. This can be achieved when learners are involved in:
    - Expressing their feelings and opinions.
    - Giving information in written form.
    - Giving instructions and directions.

SPEECH WORK

Phonetics

This is a branch of linguistics that deals with the production, transmission and perception of human speech sounds.

Branches of Phonetics

1. Articulatory Phonetics: It deals with the actual production or articulation of speech sounds. Production involves the manipulation of the speech producing organs (articulators) and the modification of the airstream mechanism which together results to meaningful sounds.
2. Auditory Phonetics: It deals with the perception or interpretation of meaningful speech sounds .i.e. the way sounds are received in through the ear. It is at this level that we draw the distinction between voiced and voiceless sounds.
3. Acoustic Phonetics: It deals with the physical property of speech sounds especially during transmission of sound waves through the air (frequency, loudness etc). It is at this level that we study pitch, volume, stress, intonation, accent etc.

Articulatory Phonetics

It deals with the actual production or articulation of speech sounds .i.e. it is concerned with the mechanics and physiology of speech production. Mechanics suggest that there is energy and movement involved in giving rise to a product (meaningful sound). This energy is called the airstream mechanism. It usually emanates from the breathing or respiratory system but specifically from the lungs.

The lungs therefore act as a source of power or 'fuel' that make speech production possible. We have three types of airstream mechanism: pulmonic, glottalic and velaric airstream mechanisms. Of the three, the pulmonic airstream mechanism is the one responsible for the major human sounds. The process of air being pushed out of the lungs is called the **egressive pulmonic**

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airstream mechanism while that of the air being pushed into the lungs is called the **ingressive pulmonic airstream mechanism**.

The movement involves the up and down movement of the intercostal muscles: when the intercostal muscles relax, the air is absorbed into the lungs while when they contract; there is air that is released from the lungs. There is also the vibration of the vocal cords and the movement of the tongue and lips.

The product involves the meaningful sounds that can be perceived and interpreted .i.e. we have attached meaning to them.

Under physiology we are concerned with the understanding the position and role of parts of the body that have specialized secondary functions. All these constitutes to what is called **Speech Organs or Vocal Organs or Articulators or Speech Production Apparatus**.

Speech Organs / Vocal Organs / Articulators / Speech Production Apparatus
They are divided into two:

1. Passive articulator
   a. Lungs
   b. Velum
   c. Upper palate / Hard Palate
   d. Teeth
2. Active articulators
   a. Tongue
   b. Lips
   c. Glottis
   d. Uvula
   e. Alveolar ridge

A Diagram Showing the Speech Organs/ Vocal Organs / Articulators / Speech Production Apparatus

Primary and Secondary Role of Speech Physiology

ORGAN	PRIMARY ROLE	SECONDARY ROLE
Lungs	Allows the movement of air into and out of the blood stream .i.e. breathing	Initiating the airstream mechanism that is modified in the process of sound production.

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Vocal Cords (Larynx / Voice Box / Adam's Apple)	Protects the lungs against objects and infection.	They either vibrate or drawn apart as the airstream passes between them: this gives the distinction between voiced (all vowel sounds and some consonant sounds .e.g. /b/, /d/, /g/) and voiceless sounds .e.g. /p/, /t/, /k/
Pharynx (Pharyngeal Cavity)	Traps pathogens	Acts as a resonator of sounds .i.e. improves the quality of sound as the airstream passes through it.
Alveolar ridge / Gum	Holds the teeth firmly in position	Works in conjunction with the tongue which either is placed near it or against it producing consonant sounds like: /r/, /l/.
Velum (Soft Palate)	Assists in the swallowing of the food.	Enables the velic closure or opening. When we have velic closure (raised velum) we have oral sounds. The tongue is placed near it or against it to produce certain sounds .e.g. /k/, /g/
Hard Palate (Palato-alveolar ridge / the roof of the oral cavity)	Aids in the softening of food.	It acts as a passive articulator. The tongue acts on it in different ways to produce certain sounds .e.g. /j/ as in 'you'
Upper Front Teeth (Upper incisors)	Biting	Passive articulators that help in production of labio-dental sounds. They modify the airstream as they act in conjunction with the lips and tongue.
Tongue	Aids in chewing / rolling food into bolus and tasting.	It is the most mobile / flexible articulator. It is involved in production of virtually all sounds. It takes different positions to aid the modification of the airstream in production of all vowels .e.g. /a/, /e/, /i/, /o/, /u/. It may also block the airstream or permit partial release of it in production of consonant sound .e.g. /t/, /d/, /n/, /l/, /r/.
Lips	To keep the mouth closed.	Block and suddenly release the

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	Keep the food in the mouth during chewing. Prevent the pathogens from entering the mouth.	airstream which aids in sound production some consonant sounds .e.g. /p/, /b/, /m/. Allow partial release of air production of some consonant sounds .e.g. /f/, /v/. Take different shapes in production of vowels.
Oral Cavity	A receptor for food.	Acts as a resonator .i.e. sound produced with the airstream being released at various parts within it results in oral sounds. The main direction where the air travels is from the lungs to the oral cavity.
Nasal Cavity	Breathing in and out .i.e. a pathway of air into and out of the lungs. Blocks pathogens from entering into the body.	Acts as a resonator .i.e. sounds produced with the airstream being released through the nose after the mouth has been closed resulting to nasal sound .e.g. /m/, / ŋ/ and /n/

Phonetic Transcriptions

These are symbols used to represent various consonant and vowel sounds

1. **Consonant Sounds**

   Parameters of Describing Consonant Sounds

   a. **State of the Glottis / Voicing**

   This is the periodic vibration of the vocal cords found within the larynx. The space between the vocal cords is called **the glottis**. The sounds produced when the vocal cords are partially closed (narrowed vibrating glottis) causing a vibration or buzzing sound are called **voiced sounds** .e.g. /b/, /v/, /g/, /d/, /ʤ/, /z/, /ð/, /ʒ/.

   The sounds produced when the vocal cords are at rest hence drawn wide apart (the glottis wide open) allowing the airstream to flow through them freely are called **voiceless sounds** .e.g. /p/, /f/, /k/, /t/, /ʧ/, /s/, /θ/, /ʃ/

   NB: - When the vocal cords are firmly held together (the glottis completely closed) so that the airstream (lungs) is completely cut off from the external air for some duration (usually a fraction of a second), it causes non-linguistic sounds like coughs, hiccups or clearing of the throat.

   b. **Place of Articulation**

   - Bilabial sounds: When both lips come together or aid in production of the sound .e.g. /p/, /b/, /m/, /w/
   - Labiodentals sounds: When the upper teeth come in contact with the lower lip .e.g. /f/, /v/
   - Dental / interdental sounds: When the tip of the tongue touches the upper teeth .e.g. /θ/, /ð/

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- Alveolar sounds: When the blade of the tongue moves near or touches the alveolar ridge .e.g. /t/, /d/, /n/, /s/, /z/, /l/, /r/
- Palatal-alveolar / Post Alveolar sounds: When the blade of the tongue moves near the place between the alveolar ridge and the hard palate then cause airstream obstruction .e.g. /ʧ/, /ʤ/, /ʃ/, /ʒ/
- Palatal sound: When the body of the tongue moves near the hard palate causing airstream obstruction .i.e. /j/
- Velar sounds: When the back of the tongue touches the velum (soft palate) causing airstream obstruction .e.g. /k/, /g/, /ŋ/
- Glottal sound: When the airstream is obstructed in the glottis .i.e. /h/

c. **Manner of Articulation**

This is how sounds are produced .i.e. what happen at the place of articulation. They include:

- Stops (Plosives) : Produced when the airstream is momentarily shut off at the point of articulation and suddenly released by the lips or the tongue causing some kind of an explosion .e.g. /p/, /b/, /t/, /d/, /k/, /g/
- Fricative: Produced when the airstream passage is narrowed so that it produces an audible friction .i.e. hissing sound .e.g. /f/, /v/, /θ/, /ð/, /s/, /z/, /ʃ/, /ʒ/, /h/
- Affricates: Produced when the airstream is blocked and released gradually .i.e. when we have a plosive and a fricative at the same time .e.g. /ʧ/, /ʤ/
- Nasals: Produced when the velum is lowered (velic opening) allowing the airstream to flow through the nasal cavity hence the sounds being produced via the nose .e.g. /m/, /n/, /ŋ/
- Laterals: Produced when the tongue blocks the airstream to flow at the centre of the mouth but bends on either sides to allow the air to pass there .e.g. /l/.
- Glides: Produced when there is no friction in articulation. They are also referred to as semi-vowels, approximants or frictionless consonants .e.g. /w/, /r/, /j/

A Table Showing the Place and Manner of Articulation of English Consonant Sounds

MANNER OF ARTICULATION	PLACE OF ARTICULATION							
	Bilabial	Labiodentals	Dentals	Alveolar	Palato-alveolar	Palatal	Velar	Glottal
Plosives / Stops	P b			t, d			k, g	
Fricatives		f, v	θ, ð	s, z	ʃ, ʒ			h
Affricates					ʧ, ʤ			
Nasals	m			n			ŋ	

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Laterals				l				
Approximants	w			r		j		

General Consonant Descriptions Tables

PLOSIVES / STOPS			
Sound	**State of the Glottis**	**Place of Articulation**	**Manner of Articulation**
/p/	Voiceless	Bilabial	Plosive
/b/	Voiced	Bilabial	Plosive
/t/	Voiceless	Alveolar	Plosive
/d/	Voiced	Alveolar	Plosive
/k/	Voiceless	Velar	Plosive
/g/	Voiced	Velar	Plosive

FRICATIVES			
Sound	**State of the Glottis**	**Place of Articulation**	**Manner of Articulation**
/f/	Voiceless	Labiodental	Fricative
/v/	Voiced	Labiodental	Fricative
/θ/	Voiceless	Dental	Fricative
/ð/	Voiced	Dental	Fricative
/s/	Voiceless	Alveolar	Fricative
/z/	Voiced	Alveolar	Fricatives
/ʃ/	Voiceless	Palato-alveolar	Fricative
/ʒ/	Voiced	Palato-alveolar	Fricative
/h/	Voiceless	Glottal	Fricative

AFFRICATES			
Sound	**State of the Glottis**	**Place of Articulation**	**Manner of Articulation**
/ʧ/	Voiceless	Plato-alveolar	Affricate
/ʤ/	Voiced	Plato-alveolar	Affricate

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NASALS			
Sound	**State of the Glottis**	**Place of Articulation**	**Manner of Articulation**
/m/	Voiced	Bilabial	Nasal
/n/	Voiced	Alveolar	Nasal
/ŋ/	Voiced	Velar	Nasal

LATERALS			
Sound	**State of the Glottis**	**Place of Articulation**	**Manner of Articulation**
/l/		Alveolar	Lateral

GLIDE / APPROXIMANT			
Sound	**State of the Glottis**	**Place of Articulation**	**Manner of Articulation**
/w/		Bilabial	Glide
/r/		Alveolar	Glide
/j/		Velar	Glide

2. **Vowel Sounds**
   All vowels are produced with the vibration of the vocal cords; therefore, they are all voiced. In the production of vowels there is no blockage of the airstream at any point but the variation in the quality of the vowels results in the different positions assumed by the tongue and different shapes assumed by the lips.

   The tongue is therefore the most important articulator in the production of vowels: it moves back and forth (horizontally) or up and down (vertically) to give us different tongue positions that we use in distinguishing vowels. As such, we have three features that we use in describing vowel sounds:
   a. Tongue position (high, mid or low positions)
   b. Tongue advancement (front, central or back).
   c. Degree of lip rounding .i.e. rounded or unrounded (spread)

   The vowels are divided into monophthongs, diphthongs and triphthongs.

<u>Monophthongs</u>
From the five vowel letters (a e i o u) we get **twelve vowel sounds** (monophthongs).i.e. **seven short vowels** and **five long vowels**.

<u>Short Vowels</u>
a. /ɪ/ or /i/ as in b**i**t, f**i**ll, p**i**n, k**i**ll, s**i**t, st**i**ll, **i**ll
b. /e/ as in b**e**t, p**e**n, t**e**ll, l**e**t, g**e**t, t**e**n, **e**bb

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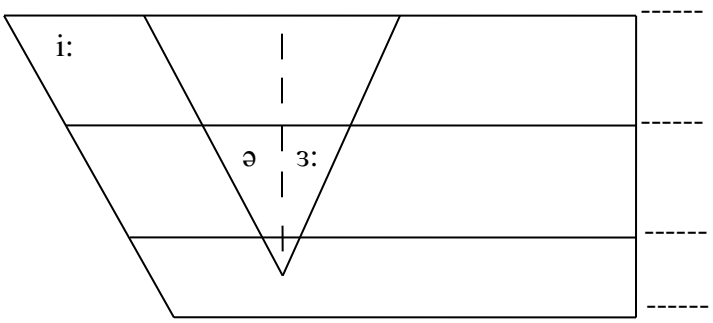
c. /æ/ or /a/ as in b**a**t, c**a**t, m**a**n, f**a**t
d. /ə/ as in **a**dore, **a**bout, moth**er**, **a**gain, **a**go, ent**er**
e. /ʌ/ as in m**u**d, b**u**d, h**u**t, c**u**p, c**u**t, b**u**t, **u**ncle, m**o**ther
f. /ʊ/ or /u/ as in p**u**ll, f**u**ll, l**oo**k, w**oo**d, b**oo**k, s**oo**t, w**oo**l
g. /ɒ/ as in p**o**t, c**o**t, r**o**d, n**o**t, g**o**t, sh**o**t, **o**n

Long Vowels
a. /i:/ as in f**ee**l, cl**ea**n, f**ea**t, b**ea**t, b**ea**n, b**ee**f, s**ea**t, st**ea**l, m**ea**l
b. /ɑ:/ or /a:/ as in c**ar**d, d**ar**k, p**ar**k, f**ar**m, c**ar**t, f**a**ther
c. /ɜ:/ as in b**ur**n, b**ir**d, w**or**d, sh**ir**t, f**ir**st, n**ur**se, f**ur**, f**ir**m
d. /u:/ as in fool, pool, food, too, boom, tomb
e. /ɔ:/ or /o:/ sh**or**t, s**aw**, b**ore**, c**o**ke, p**or**t, t**or**n, c**or**d, w**ar**d

The above vowel sounds (monophthongs) can be represented in a vowel trapezium to show different positions of the tongue as follows:



Diphthongs
These are sequence of two vowels that occur together in a word and are therefore considered as a single sound unit. They are divided into two categories:
a. Centering Diphthongs
This a combination of a cardinal vowel and a mid high central vowel as in the vowel trapezium below:
i. /ɪə/ as in **ear**, h**ear**, d**ear**, t**ier**, t**ear**, r**ear**, h**ere**, app**ear**, b**eer**, n**ear**, d**eer**, b**ear**d, f**ear**, f**ier**ce, y**ear**, c**lear**
ii. /ʊə/ as in p**oor**, s**ure**, end**ure**, t**our**, cure, tour, pure, bluer
iii. /eə/ as in air, bear, dare, hare, care, rare, fair, pair, bare, f**are**, p**ear**, h**eir**
b. Closing Diphthongs / Rising Diphthongs
They are a combination of lower (open) cardinal vowel with a high (close) cardinal vowel or a mid-high central vowel /ə/ with a high cardinal vowel as illustrated in the vowel trapezium below:

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i. /ɔɪ/ as in b**oy**, toil, voyage, toy, avoid, voice, annoy, destroy, oil, join, hoist, boil, noise, void
ii. /aʊ/ as in how, howl, cow, out, proud, brown, pound, drown, fowl, now, ouch, loud, found, doubt, town
iii. /eɪ/ as in say, aim, age, fail, break, able, great, late, paper, rake, sail, sale, trail, trade, made, maid, paid
iv. /aɪ/ as in eye, die, lie, kind, wild, tight, guide, sky, mice, rice, like, lice, life, time, tide, nice
v. /əʊ/ as in go, old, sew, know, no, oval, told, throw, loaf, rope, load, goat, coat, so, toast, broke.

Triphthongs

This is formed with the combination of three vowel sounds .i.e.

i. /eɪ/ + /ə/ = /eɪə/ as in layer, player
ii. /aɪ/ + /ə/ = /aɪə/ as in liar, fire, tyre
iii. /ɔɪ/ + /ə/ = /ɔɪə/ as in loyal, royal
iv. /əʊ/ + /ə/ = /əʊə/ as in lower, mower
v. /aʊ/ + /ə/ = /aʊə/ as in power, hour, coward, flour, flower

Pronunciation Problems

a. Vowel displacement
This arises from the long vowels and more number of vowels that are in English language than other languages. For instance:
/æ/ hat and /ʌ/ hut
/ɑ:/ fast and /ɜ:/ first
/ɜ:/ hurt and /ɑ:/ heart
/ɪ/ live and /i:/ leave
/ɒ/ pot and /ɔ:/ port

b. Simplification of diphthongs
Speakers tend to reduce the second element in the diphthongs to form monophthongs, for example:
/ei/ becomes /e/
gate get
shade shed

/əʊ/ becomes /ɒ/
coat cot
goat got

c. Insertion of vowels
Speakers break the consonant clusters and insert a vowel (usually /i/ or /ə/ & /e/) between them. This happens both between and within words. For instance:
/heləp/ for help instead of /help/
/mɪlik/ for milk instead of /mɪlk/
/ju:silesi/ for useless instead of /ju:sləs/
/stændədiseveni/ for standard seven instead of /stændədsevn/

d. Consonant displacement

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Speakers find consonants that are not in their language difficult to pronounce hence replacing them. For example:

/r/ becomes /l/

read	lead
rid	lid
river	liver

/ʃ/ becomes /s/

sheep	sip
she	see

/ʃ/ becomes /tʃ/

wash	watch
cash	catch

e. Voicing problems

Speakers substitute voiced/voiceless consonants with the equivalent voiceless/voiced consonants respectively, for example:

/p/ becomes /b/		/f/ becomes /v/		/t/ becomes /d/	
pit	bit	ferry	very	ten	den
pay	bay	fan	van	talk	dog

/s/ becomes /z/		/k/ becomes /g/	
price	prize	back	bag
sip	zip	cook	goog

f. Omission or insertion of /h/

Speakers may omit or add the phoneme /h/ unnecessarily, mostly at the beginning of words. For instance:

air for hare and vice versa
ear for here and vice versa
art for hurt and vice versa.

g. Prenasalisation of consonants

Speakers with nasal sounds like /m/, /n/ and /ŋ/ preceding consonants /b/, /t/, /d/, /k/ and /g/ in their mother tongue tend to transfer the same to English language. For instance:

/**m**bɔ:ɪ / for boy instead of /bɔ:ɪ/
/**m**bʊk/ for book instead of /bʊk/
/**ŋ**get/ for get instead of /get/
/ɪmpɔ:**n**tnt/ for important instead of /ɪmpɔ:tnt/

Solutions to Pronunciation Problems

The teacher should:

a. Explain the state of the glottis, place of articulation and manner of articulation of some troublesome sounds in English.
b. Provide sufficient exposure of the learners to the relevant sounds using minimal pairs, for example:

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/ɪ/ and /i:/
sit seat
live leave
bit beat
lid lead

c. Encourage pupils to make conscious effort when articulating problematic sounds.
d. Be a role model to the learners by articulating the sounds as accurate as possible.
e. Provide sufficient oral lessons where learners can practice the sounds through dialogues, drama, poems, tongue twisters and songs.

SCHEMES OF WORK, LESSON PLANS AND PROGRESS RECORDS

1. Schemes of Work

This is a written plan which shows a breakdown of topics intended to be covered in a specified period of time (weekly, termly or yearly)

Sources of Schemes of Work

a. The English syllabus

b. The school timetable – It stipulates the number of lessons to be taught each week.

c. Approved and prescribed course books (Pupil's Book and Teacher's Guide)

d. Supplementary materials and reference books.

e. Teacher's notes and timetables for radio lessons.

f. The school calendar of events.

Functions of the English Syllabus

a. To identify objectives, language items and language skills to be taught.

b. To identify the teaching and learning activities.

c. Provides a guideline to proper arrangement of language items .i.e. oral work (listening and speaking), reading and writing.

Importance of Schemes of Work

a. Specifies the content to be covered in each lesson thus assisting in the teaching of the lesson.

b. Makes the learning process systematic.

c. Assists the teacher to plan for remedial work.

d. Enables the teacher to know the extent of syllabus coverage.

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Elements of Schemes of Work

a. Week

It is the week of the term. Written in numbers .i.e. 1,2,3…

b. Lesson

It shows the number of lesson per week. Lower primary has five lessons while upper primary has seven lessons. Written in numbers .i.e. 1,2,3…

c. Topic

It indicates the language skill to be taught .i.e. oral work, reading or writing respectively.

d. Subtopic

It indicates the specified content or area to be covered in that topic. Therefore, we cover the following subtopics under each skill:

- Oral skill: The subtopics include:
  - ✓ Vocabulary .i.e. content words .e.g. verbs, nouns, adjectives, adverbs and some preposition.
  - ✓ Sentence patterns and structures .i.e. structured words or functional words .e.g. auxiliary verbs, pronouns, determiners and conjunctions.
  - ✓ Grammar .i.e. word classes (parts of speech), singular and plural forms, positive and negative forms and tenses.
  - ✓ Extended oral work lessons (listening and speaking) .e.g. narratives, poems, conversations, drama, debates or audiovisual / radio lessons.
- Reading: This is usually a comprehension. The subtopics includes:
  - ✓ Passages
  - ✓ Excerpts from novels or plays.
  - ✓ Library lessons
- Writing: The subtopics include:
  - ✓ Handwriting
  - ✓ Spelling and word formations
  - ✓ Punctuation

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- ✓ Sentence patterns / language practice (filling in gaps, matching sentences, rewriting sentences and paragraphs, adding question tags, using substitution table to construct sentences)
- ✓ Choice, length and organization of content
- ✓ Imaginative compositions (picture or guided compositions)
- ✓ Functional writings .i.e. format and layout.

e. Objectives

They indicate what type of learning that will have taken place at the end of the lesson. They should be SMART .i.e. Specific, Measurable, Achievable (Attainable), Realistic and Time bound. They should also be stated from the point of view of the individual learner .e.g.

By the end of the lesson, the learner should be able to:

- Articulate the new words correctly.
- Explain the meaning of the new words correctly.
- Construct correct sentences using the new words learnt.

In stating objectives, avoid terms like: know, learn, understand, improve, increase, appreciate and enjoy as they are not observable or achievable. The teacher should therefore ask himself or herself the following questions:

- Is the objective achievable by the end of the lesson?
- Does the objective focus on what the pupil will learn rather than what the teacher will teach?
- What will be the behavior of the learner to indicate he or she has learnt?

f. Teaching activities

They indicate the expected step by step delivery of the lesson by the teacher. Each teaching activity should be in tandem with a learning activity.

g. Learning activities

They indicate the expected step by step reactions, performances or responds to the teaching activity. Each learning activity should be in tandem with a teaching activity.

h. Teaching and learning aids

They indicate the specific learning resources to be used in the lesson .e.g. flash cards, pictures, charts or real objects to enhance teaching and learning process.

i. References

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They indicate where the information will be found .e.g. the Teachers' Book, Pupils' Book and any other supplementary materials. The title and the page of the reference book **MUST** be quoted.

j. Remarks

Remarks are filled in after the lesson has been taught. They should be very informative about the outcome of the lesson based on the teacher's objective opinion. They should show whether the lesson was taught or not. If it was not taught, the reason should be given then an intended date when the lesson is expected to be covered. If the lesson was taught, the remarks should indicate whether the objectives were achieved or not. If the objectives were not achieved, the aspects of the lesson that need improvement should be highlighted with the method of improvement specified.

Sample of Schemes of Work for Lower Primary

Week	Lesson	Topic	Subtopic	Objectives	Teaching Activities	Learning Activities	Teaching / Learning Aids	References	Remarks

2. Lesson Plan

It is a detailed account of the lesson preparation and development. This should be done prior to the start of the lesson. The teacher should imagine himself or herself in class and give an expected detailed step by step account of the lesson proceedings. It is derived from the plan in the schemes of work and written on daily basis.

Importance of a Lesson Plan

a. Ensures that the objectives are measurable and achievable within a specified time.

b. Enables easy, efficient and smooth progress of the lesson as teaching and learning activities are already planned for.

c. Enables us to make suitable, relevant, appropriate, interesting and attractive choice of examples and teaching/learning aids for the lesson.

d. Ensures that we have varied and well balanced lesson activities.

e. Enables the teacher to concentrate on the language skill of the day.

f. In case of the lesson involving group work, the teacher is able to prepare for activities of each group in advance.

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Elements of a Lesson Plan

a. Class, subject, date, time and roll.
b. Topic – It indicates the language skill to be taught .i.e. oral work, reading or writing respectively as indicated in the schemes of work.
c. Subtopic – It indicates the specified content or area to be covered in that topic as indicated in the schemes of work.
d. Objectives – They indicate what type of learning that will have taken place at the end of the lesson as indicated in the schemes of work.
e. Teaching / Learning aids – They indicate the specific learning resources to be used in the lesson as indicated in the schemes of work.
f. References – They indicate where the information was be found as indicated in the schemes of work.
g. Lesson development – It covers step by step delivery of the lesson under the subheadings: steps / time, teaching activities and learning activities.
    - Introduction – This where we use the new structure or language item in meaningful context or a situation in the classroom that is familiar to the students, for instance, songs, poems, short narratives (anecdotes). You may also display visual aids like a picture or real object or use demonstration accompanied with questioning techniques.
    - Presentation – This is where we use the correct sentence structure or language item in the context that brings out its meaning clearly then write on the chalkboard. Depending on the type of the sentence structure or language item to be taught, use an appropriate technique for conveying the appropriate pattern or meaning of words like use of different examples, discussions, explanations, descriptions or pupils' general knowledge of the word.

      This also covers imitation .i.e. the teacher provides the correct model with correct pronunciation, stress and intonation then lets the learners repeat the model orally either individually, or in pairs or in a group. Listen carefully as they say it and correct errors if any. Sentence patterns and language items that prove to be persistently problematic should be isolated and practiced on their own. Make sure the learners do not just chant without understanding the appropriate sentence pattern.
    - Application: This involves practice and reinforcement of the content. The teacher emphasizes meaningful practice through continuous repetition of the sentence pattern or language items in different situations. Practice new sentence structure or language items through question and answer or instruction and response method as a group, in pairs or even individuals. However, the response from the learners must contain the new structure or language items. You can use classroom situations or visual aids to accompany the practice activity.

      In reinforcement, the newly taught patterns or language items are emphasized through reading passages and poems, games, songs, poems, dialogues, conversations, short narratives, use of written exercises or art work such drawings.

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- Conclusion: This involves the summative details of the lesson. It may be through use of oral questions to evaluate the learner's mastery of content and assess whether the objective was achieved.

h. Chalkboard layout
This should be partitioned into three sections. On the left-hand side of the board, from the learners' position while facing the chalkboard, the class is indicated and underlined. This is also the part we write new language items in a vocabulary lesson and any rough work in class like students' responses. In the middle part, the subject, topic and subtopic are written then underlined. This is also the part we write the main notes. The right-hand side, from the learners' position while facing the chalkboard, we write the date and underline it. This is also the place we mount charts, if any.

i. Self-evaluation
This is filled in after the lesson has been taught. It should be very informative about the outcome of the lesson based on the teacher's objective opinion. It should show whether the objectives were achieved or not. If the objectives were not achieved, the aspects of the lesson that need improvement should be highlighted with the method of improvement specified.

A Sample of a Lesson Plan

CLASS	SUBJECT	DATE	TIME	ROLL
3W	ENGLISH	28/10/2013	11.00 – 11.30 AM	37

Topic: Oral Work
Subtopic: Vocabulary
Objectives: By the end of the lesson, the learner should be able to:
a. Articulate the new words correctly.
b. Explain the meaning of the new words correctly.
c. Construct correct sentences using the new words.
Teaching / Learning aids: Picture in the Pupils' Book Pg 34. Flashcards
References: Progress in English Pupils' Book 3 Pg. 34. Progress in English Teachers' Guide Book 3 Pg. 16.

LESSON DEVELOPMENT

STEPS / TIME	TEACHING ACTIVITIES	LEARNING ACTIVITIES

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Introduction **(7 Min)**	Use an anecdote that has the new words about a pupil who arrived late to school. Ask oral questions like, "Where did the pupil hide?" "What did he see in his hiding place?"	Listen. Answer oral questions.
Presentation **(8 Min)**	Guide the learner to: Articulate the new words correctly from the flashcards. Explain the meaning of the new words correctly.	Articulate the new words correctly. Listen.
Application **(10 Min)**	Construct correct sentences using new words. Give a written exercise. Mark some books and correct where necessary.	Construct correct sentences using new words. Do the written exercise. Correct where necessary.
Conclusion **(5 Min)**	Summarize the main points .i.e. meaning of the new words and their use in different contexts through the use of questions like, "What is the meaning of hide?" "Who can use the word 'discover' to construct a correct sentence?"	Answer oral questions.

CHALKBOARD LAYOUT

CLASS 3W Hide Discover Carcass Plantation Tricky Gullible	ENGLISH ORAL WORK VOCABULARY a. Hide – To put something in a place where it cannot be seen or found. b. Discover – To find out about something. c. Carcass – The dead body of an animal.	28/10/2013

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SELF-EVALUATION

……
……
……

3. Progress Records

These are documents that show individual pupil's progress in performance on weekly basis in different subjects. This progress is only on the daily class work given excluding formal tests done after a period of time. All the marks are added up at the end of every week then percentages calculated.

Importance of English Progress Records

a. Help to assess individual pupil's progress in learning and development of various skills.
b. Help to make decisions on whether the child is ready for exams or not.
c. Help to find out whether the pupils have a common problem in learning.
d. Help to find out whether remedial teaching is necessary.
e. Give a picture on whether the pupils have grasped the content of a specific topic.
f. Help teachers to give parents accurate feedback on the progress of their children.
g. Provides a permanent reference record about the pupil's performance and ability.

Sample of Progress Records

ENGLISH PROGRESS RECORDS FOR CLASS 3W TERM 3 2013.

	MONTH	GENDER	SEPTEMBER					TOTALS	%	GRADES	REMARKS	SEPTEMBER					TOTALS	%	GRADES	REMARKS
	WEEK		ONE									TWO								
	DAY		M	T	W	T	F					M	T	W	T	F				
	DATE		2	3	4	5	6					9	10	11	12	13				
	OUT OF																			
	NAME																			
1	Abigael Wema	G										9	10	11	12	13				
2	Faith Juma	G										9	10	11	12	13				
3	Leah Were	G										9	10	11	12	13				
4	James Tom	B										9	10	11	12	13				

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5	Kevin Kamau	B										9	10	11	12	13				

TEACHING ENGLISH IN LOWER PRIMARY

Skills Taught in English

a. Listening
b. Speaking
c. Reading
d. Writing

Note that no skill above can be taught independently.

Teaching Listening and Speaking

These are called oral skills. Oral means spoken rather than written or verbal or produced by mouth.

General Functions of Oral Works

a. Introduces and teaches new language items.
b. Drills the pupils on the use of new language items.
c. Helps to practice the newly taught language items orally with the guidance of the teacher.
d. Develops and improves speech skills like pronunciation, stress and intonation.

Specific Functions of Oral Work in Lower Primary

a. Builds up the pupils' vocabulary and sentence patterns.
b. Develops pupils, ability to understand spoken language.
c. Prepares pupils for language items they will need later in reading and writing.
d. Evaluates oral, reading and writing skills.

General Approach to Oral Skills

The teacher should make English meaningful to the pupils right from class one through the following approach:

a. Avoid use of sophisticated vocabulary or grammar terms like paraphernalia, rendezvous, flabbergasted and long or wordy explanations.
b. Use meaningful situations like:
    - Pictures

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- Drawings
- Paintings
- Real objects
- Models or audio visual aids
- Meaningful classroom situations
- Imagined situations from real life experiences
- Simple actions and mimes
- Simple demonstrations or dramatization / role-play
- Gestures, signs and facial expressions
- Songs and poems with rhyme and rhythm
- Analogies like a man is to cry as a monkey is to chatter
- System like the clock and clock face
- Opposites or contrast like head is to tail as front is to back
- Explanations
- Synonyms and homophones.
- Contexts such as phrases or sentences and clauses.
- Game and game activities

c. Avoid translation or direct translation because:
   I. It minimizes exposure to English language
   II. Limits the learner's efforts to decode English language
   III. Confuses learners in getting the English language items which do not have equivalents in mother tongue and also sentence patterns.

However, mother tongue can be resorted to when:

I. There is an emergency like an accident in class.
II. Instruction of a particular activity requires the use of a language level beyond that of the pupil or teacher needs to give quick instructions to get the learning activity going on, for instance, language games.

d. Give thorough practices i.e. have a reasonable repetition of language items through groups, pairs or just as individuals. For instance, analogy may be followed by language games.

<u>Teaching New Vocabulary Items Orally</u>

Content or lexical words (nouns, verbs, adverbs, and adjectives) and some prepositions are taught orally as vocabulary. Structural or functional words (pronouns, auxiliary verbs, determiners and conjunctions) are learnt as part of sentence structures and patterns.

<u>Types of Vocabulary</u>

a. Productive / active vocabulary – words that are easily understood and used regularly.
b. Passive vocabulary – words that are recognized but not regularly used.

<u>Procedure for Teaching New Vocabulary Items Orally</u>

a. Introduction
   Use a context or a situation in the classroom that is familiar to the students, for instance, songs, poems, short narratives (anecdotes). You may also display visual aids like a picture or real object or use demonstration accompanied with questioning technique.

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b. Presentation
   Use correct pronunciation, stress and intonation. Depending on the type of the vocabulary item, use an appropriate technique for conveying the meaning like use of different examples, discussions, explanations or descriptions.
c. Imitation
   Let students repeat orally your model either individually, or in pairs or in a group. Correct pronunciation problems if any. Word that proves to be persistently problematic should be isolated and practiced on its own. Make sure students do not just chant without understanding the meaning or the use of the items.
d. Practice
   Emphasize meaningful practice. Practice new items through question and answer or instruction and response method as a group, in pairs or even individuals. You can use classroom situations or visual aids to accompany the practice activity.

e. Reinforcement
   Encourage learners to use the newly learnt items in classroom situation, during the same lesson or later. You may also use games, songs, poems, dialogues, conversations or short narratives. One may also give written exercise but on minimal basis.

Teaching Sentence Patterns and Structures

a. Identify the pattern to be taught from the syllabus.
b. Ensure the sentence patterns have familiar items that have been taught.
c. Any other additional item to the given pattern should be selected within the range of the vocabulary of the learners and what makes sense especially at this stage of practice.
d. Guide and provide students with sufficient examples before asking them to contribute or respond.
e. Use visual aids to accompany situations in which the pattern is practiced to enhance meaning.

Examples of Activities for Practicing Sentence Patterns

a. Imitation Drill
   Let students repeat orally your sentence pattern either individually, or in pairs or in a group. Use the drill sufficiently so as the students become confident with the newly taught sentence patterns and structures.
b. Question and Answer Drill
   Ask a series of questions in a classroom situation or basing the question on the visual aids or contexts for enhancing the meaning of the pattern.
c. Substitution Drill
   Guide students construct sentences patterns similar to the ones taught.
d. Reinforcement
   Reinforce the newly taught pattern through poems, songs, short stories and language games.

Advantages of Pairs and Small Groups for Practice Activities

- Each learner is given an opportunity to use the new pattern.

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- Pupils learn from one another.
- Pupils work more independently.

Note:
The average size of the group is six pupils per group. They should be of mixed abilities for oral work.

How to Respond to the Learners' Performance

a. Detect and evaluate any error made and assist the learner in correcting them. You can also allow peer correction.
b. Appreciate the learner's effort to use the correct pronunciation, learnt item or sentence pattern and acknowledge good response.

Causes of Errors in Oral Skills

a. If the teacher's model is faulty or unclear.
b. When the learner has not been given sufficient exposure to the new item or has not internalized the sound pattern.
c. Unclear instructions given by the teacher.
d. Mother tongue influence.
e. Speech defects, for instance, stammering.

Procedure & types of Correcting a Pupil

a. Allow the learners make attempts and DO NOT correct the pupil during the first attempt on new patterns or items. Provide sufficient models first.
b. Teacher correction i.e. provide the correct form and let the learner repeat it.
c. Peer correction i.e. ask another learner to provide the correct form as the one who made the error repeats.
d. Self correction i.e. encourage the learners to correct themselves by providing clues like the use of gestures or teaching aids.

Methods of Teaching Listening and Speaking Skills

a. Dictation
b. Dialogue / conversation
c. Description and Explanation
d. Role-play
e. Dramatization and demonstrations
f. Narration or story telling
g. Audio-visual teaching.

Teaching Reading in Lower Primary

Reading is the act of getting meaning from print or any other symbols.

Process of reading involve:

a. Decoding

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Developing the ability to assign meaning to word by relating the letter sounds or symbols to the object they represent.

b. Thought
Responding to the word so that you have the meaning and image of the object represented by the word in mind.

c. Socialization
Making the word familiar and friendly to the learner so that he or she can appreciate the value of English language as an essential tool of communication.

Importance of Reading

a. Learning / didactic value
It helps acquire knowledge that is goal – oriented or utilitarian, for instance, reading for academic reasons.

b. Survival
Adds value to our survival skills, for instance, interpreting road signs.

c. Pleasure/entertainment
Reading for enjoyment, for instance, reading a novel at free time.

Functions of a Teacher in a Reading Lesson

a. Assists the learner to develop sounds of the English language.
b. Bridges the gap between the sentences read and the learner by relating the teaching and learning activities to the learner's social life.
c. Provides the learner with time to make his/her own interpretation of the words, texts or pictures.

Factors that Contribute to the Learner's Readiness to Read

a. Intelligence level
b. Ability and fluency in speaking the first language (mother tongue)
c. Home background

Pre – reading Skills

a. Visual Skills (use of sense of sight)

Abilities to be acquired

- Seeing clearly
- Recognizing differences and similarities of shapes and sizes (visual discrimination)
- Differentiating and relating colours
- Possessing visual memory
- Direction of reading i.e. from left to right
- Avoiding mirror writing e.g. 'was' for 'saw,

Activities to Help Practice the Skill

- Marching similar pictures
- Odd one-out activities
- Tell similarities and differences in colours
- Identify similarities and differences in shapes and sizes
- Describing pictures shown and then removed

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b. Auditory Skills (use of sense of hearing)

Abilities to be acquired

- Hearing clearly
- Differentiating sounds (sound discrimination), for instance, the minimal pairs like '**p**ack' and '**b**ack' or 'l**i**t' and 'l**e**t' or '**r**ot' and '**l**ot' or 'ha**t**' and 'ha**d**'
- Hear rhyming words and sounds, for instance, 'ri**ng**' and 'si**ng**'
- Listen and respond to simple instructions.

Activities to Help Practice the Skill

- Listening to songs
- Listen and differentiate sounds
- Identify sources of sounds, for instances, from animals or machines.
- Listen to the rhythm and dance to it.
- Identify rhyming words
- Simple dramatization of stories told
- Repeating the list of words as pronounced

c. Speech Skills (oral skill)

Abilities to be acquired

- Pronounce words and sounds correctly and appropriately
- Sufficient vocabulary
- Use of varied sentence structures
- Thinking sequentially

Activities to Help Practice the Skill

- Re-telling part of the story sequentially
- Singing
- Reciting poems with rhymes
- Practice saying minimal pairs
- Reciting tongue twisters

d. Attitudinal Skills

Abilities to be acquired

- Concentrate and recall things
- Read and enjoy being read to.
- Able to work both individually and with others

Activities to Help Practice the Skill

- Listen to the teacher reading
- Work in groups, pairs or individually

e. Manual skills

Abilities to be acquired

- Drawing
- Representing words in print i.e. letter writing
- Modeling

Activities to Help Practice the Skill

- Express concepts through painting, tracing drawings and modeling.
- Writing the alphabetical letters

Functions of Pre-reading Skills

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They help the learner to:

a. Distinguish letters and sounds
b. Hear and distinguish the sounds of the language and relate them to printed words or letters.
c. Understand the words they read and gain ability to use them in sentences
d. Understand the meaning of the written sentences

Informal Activities for Introducing Reading in English

a. Name cards
   These are cards with individual names of learners. They may be put on their desks or tables. They help the learners recognize their names and those of others.

b. Picture labels
   These are labels that may be detachable and placed on classroom objects or pictures. Learners can use them actively, moving and replacing them according to the teacher's instruction.
c. Caption cards
   These can be made for classroom objects such as curiosity chart.

Methods of Teaching Reading

1. Look-and-say method
   Display a new word, phrase or sentence on the chalkboard and say it clearly as the learners look at it. Repeat it severally for learners to memorize it. You may also use a visual reminder like pictures or real objects to enhance memory.

   Purpose of Look-and-Say Method
   a. Helps learners to build a 'sight vocabulary' using selected words that they can recognize instantly by their shape, height and other visual cues.
   b. The words are given meaning by being linked with the corresponding spoken form and the object they represent.
   c. Builds a three-way association for each word i.e. sound → word → referent.

   Advantages of Look-and-Say Method
   a. Reading vocabulary is systematically acquired and thoroughly revised.
   b. Learners can begin to read meaningful material at sentence level, if the teacher provides adequate labels, vocabulary chart to reinforce language items taught.
   c. Learners can read both regularly and irregularly spelt words like who, you and what at an early stage.
   d. Easy to guide learners to form their own stories and sentences using the words learnt.
   e. Graded reading series may be required for proper teaching.
   f. Learners gain confidence in reading as they read after the teacher.
   g. Enhances sight vocabulary.

   Disadvantages of Look-and-Say Method
   a. Familiarization with reading vocabulary will be rather slow since each word has to be learnt first.

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b. Slows down learning process as each word is presented in sequential order.
c. Similarly-looking words and mirror words are likely to be confused, for instance, 'her' and 'here' or 'on' and 'no' respectively.
d. Learners are unable to tackle unfamiliar word and are therefore dependent on the teacher for further progress.
e. As vocabulary increases, the learner's memory is strained.

Suitable Practice Activities for Look-and-Say Method

The learner should:

a. Participate in team competition
b. Match a word on a flashcard with the same word on the chalkboard either in list or in sentence.
c. Identify a word by choosing the corresponding flashcard or pointing to it on the chalkboard as the teacher says it.
d. Say the word as the teacher indicates it on the chalkboard or displays it briefly on the flashcard.
e. Silently match a word, phrase or sentence with its visual referent, for instance, an object or picture.
f. Engage in a class/teacher contest.
g. Choose flashcards to fill a gap in the sentence so that it corresponds to the spoken sentence.

Lesson Procedure for 'Look-and-Say' Method

a. Oral practice and revision of the word
   Revise the words orally through: question technique, visual aids, demonstrations or sketches on the chalkboard.
b. Presentation of the word in the written form
   Present a written form on the chalkboard or flashcard. Read the word as the learner looks at it and listen.
c. Imitation or repetition
   Read the word with correct pronunciation, intonation and stress as the learner repeats.
d. Practice stage
   Let the learner identify the new word from the list of others which they already know and practice it on its own or in context. This can be done in pairs, group or individually.

2. The phonic method

It is based on the regular correspondence or relationship between the sounds of the language and the letters that are used to represent these sounds in writing. The relationship is taught systematically so that when the learners are confronted with unfamiliar or have forgotten a word, they will be able to work out its meaning by analyzing its constituent letters and group of letter sounds. There should be constant practice to enhance speed of mastery.

Skills that Phonic Approach Depends on

a. Ability to discriminate accurately between the different sounds of the language concerned e.g. difference in pronunciation of 'goat' and 'coat'

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b. Ability to recognize individual letters and common letter groupings and to distinguish these from other letters which are similar in appearance and therefore potentially, confusing e.g. b/d, f/t, u/n.

Note: The development of these skills should begin at pre-reading stage.

Activities used to Teach Phonic Skills

a. Creating a phonic corner where we can have words that begin with same letters e.g. deal, dead, dean, deem.
b. Group and class language games based on phonic skills.
c. Reciting short poems and rhymes.
d. Adaptation of words using sounds and letter cards.
e. Missing letter exercise
f. Comparison of new words with others in the same phonic family.
g. Word-building using individual letter card or sound cards i.e. cards showing a single letter or a group of letters representing a single sound like: pa + ra + de = parade
h. Making a series of words with particular sound-letter relationship using aids such as the phonic wheel and the phonic slide or letter substitution grid.
i. Reciting tongue twisters with particular sounds.

Advantages of Phonic Method

a. Equips learners with reading skills which help them to be independent readers.
b. Suitable for all pupils in terms of reading ability.
c. Enhances spelling skills which are reinforced in writing skills.

Disadvantages of Phonic Method

a. It overemphasizes on pronunciation leaving little time for other learning activities like explanation of meaning of words.
b. Single letter words taught using it have no meaning.
c. Time consuming as one has to teach single letter sounds before moving to words.
d. It is difficult to use it with words whose pronunciation does not match with the spelling.

Comparison between Look-and-Say With Phonic Method

Look-and-Say Method	**Phonic Method**
Deals with whole words and whole sentences.	Deals with single letter sound
Pupils develop over-dependence on the teacher on reading.	Pupils develop independence in reading
Meaning of whole words and whole sentences is conveyed in meaningful situations.	Letter sounds in isolation have no meaning

Skills Used to Introduce New Words / Word Attack Skills

a. Picture clues which reinforce meaning of the sentence.

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b. Context clues i.e. semantic and syntactic clues which enable the learner to work out the meaning of words as used in context.
c. Comparison of known words with new words in the same phonic family e.g. pool, cool, wool, wood, good.
d. Analyzing compound words such as classroom, shopkeeper, watchman and housemate when both of the constituent words are already known.
e. Use of affix i.e. both prefix and suffixes

Reading Problems Experienced by Pupils

a. Reading without understanding due to insufficient oral competence.
b. Forgetting items taught earlier which limits reading progress.
c. Confusion of letters and words which are similar.
d. Bad reading habits such as finger-pointing, lip movement, head movement, reading from bottom to top of the page and backtracking.
e. Missing out words or sections from a reading text and replacing them with their own.

Method of Correcting Reading Problems

a. Provide simpler alternative reading material for the remedial group.
b. Encourage learners to use any available reading materials to practice reading at home.
c. Maintain proper record of pupils' reading progress with additional notes on pupils who need extra assistance.

Teaching Procedure for Reading

a. Oral presentation
    - Revise words and sentence patterns related to the text to be read through anecdotes and simple explanations.
    - Discuss picture(s) accompanying the text to be read
b. Word recognition activities
   Present on the chalkboard the word(s) using:
    - Phonic activities, for instance, letter cards, sound cards, and phonic wheel/slide.
    - Look-and-say activities, for instance, the fishing game, lucky dip, snaps game, bingo.
c. Guided reading at sentence level
    - Allow learners to read aloud individually or in pairs, groups or as a whole class after providing the right model by first reading the passage.
    - Introduce gradually silent reading.
d. Checking understanding
    - Guide the learners to paint, draw, sing or dramatize what they have read.
    - Ask simple oral questions from the passage.
    - Allow the learners to re-tell the story in their own words.
    - Allow the learners to attempt some of the written exercises in their exercise books.

Grouping Pupils

Ways of Grouping Pupils

a. Ability grouping i.e. putting pupils of the same ability together.

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b. Mixed ability grouping i.e. mixing pupils of different abilities.
c. Social grouping i.e. according to how they socialize.
d. Interest grouping i.e. putting pupils of similar interest together.
e. Gender grouping i.e. putting pupils of same sex together.

Advantages of Group Work in a Language Lesson

a. Learning is self-directed and pupils become active in their learning. They learn at their own pace and speed.
b. High pupil participation and a faster way of doing exercises.
c. Easy to tackle different topics or contents simultaneously.
d. Inculcates teamwork in learners and slow learners benefit from fast learners.
e. Provides an opportunity to use language in real situations.
f. It is easy to attend to the weaker group.

Disadvantages of Group Work in a Language Lesson

a. It is demanding to organize and prepare materials needed by each group.
b. Group control is difficult when different groups carry out different activities.
c. It is difficult to evaluate group work and it cannot give accurate feedback.
d. Fast learners may finish their work faster leaving the slow learners to lag behind.
e. Difficult to have individual evaluation.

Teaching Writing in Lower Primary

Writing is the ability to communicate ideas, opinion, instructions or any information through print, signs and symbols.

Sub-Skills in Writing

a. Handwriting
b. Vocabulary
c. Spelling and word formation
d. Grammar
e. Punctuation
f. Sentence construction
g. Choice and organization of content
h. Format and layout

Aspects of Writing

a. Manipulative task for handwriting i.e. the way the pencil is held in order to form letters.
b. The creative task i.e. the ideas that come from the writer.

Pre-Writing Skills

a. Visual or perceptual skill (sight skill).
b. Ability to move the arm and hand.
c. Eye – hand coordination
d. Muscle coordination i.e. left to right eye and hand movement.
e. Auditory skill
f. Ability to hold the pencil properly

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Pre-Writing Activities

a. Practice to write words which have been displayed and removed.
b. Exercise drawing, writing patterns, colouring, tracing, painting, modeling, cutting out shapes using a pair of scissors, building up shapes using blocks, making patterns with objects, games like snake and ladder, ludo and dominoes.
c. Practice copying single words or letters from the chalkboard.
d. Practice writing on slates, trays, soil or air and taking a finger for a walk.
e. Practice writing words as dictated.
f. Controlled or guided letter-writing that emphasizes on correct spacing between letters and words as well as correct letter formation and alignment.
g. Holding a pen properly or in correct position.
h. Giving left to right direction.

Handwriting

This should be first taught in mother tongue in lower primary.

Sub-Skills in Handwriting

a. Letter formation
b. Letter shaping
c. Letter spacing in words
d. Word spacing in sentences
e. Alignment

Teaching Procedure for Handwriting

a. Revision of previous letters already learnt, if any, as a warm up exercise.
b. Pattern practice.
   Guide learners to copy one or more patterns which will help them practice the hand movement needed for the new letters. You can also go through other various pre-writing activities like drawing and tracing.
c. Demonstration and imitation
   - Demonstrate the formation of the letters and let the learners imitate the movement.
   - Draw the letter in the air and let the learners imitate with their fingers.
   - Allow learners to draw the letters on top of their desks or soil.
d. Individual practice.
   Allow the learners to copy two or three letters severally in their exercise books.
e. Practice of the letters in words.
   Allow learners to copy the words containing the new letters. The word should be familiar and containing letters leant previously. Finally move to sentences then short paragraphs.

NB: - Introduce lower case for words and upper case for sentences in class one.

Handwriting Difficulties

a. Poor letter formation i.e. badly shaped letters.
b. Dismembered or disjoined letters, for instance, ‘ol’ for ‘d’ or ‘lc’ for ‘k’

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c. Mirror writing i.e. letters written from back to front, for instance, ‘s’ or ‘b/d’
d. Poor alignment i.e. writing across the horizontal line.
e. Mixing of small letters with capital letters, for instance, ‘motHER’ or ‘FAther’
f. Improper or irregular spacing between letters and words, for instance, ‘The b o y came veryfirst’
g. Irregularly sized letters

Causes of Writing Problems

a. Lack of thorough preparation before the writing skill. This preparation is supposed to be done orally.
b. Lack of sufficient and thorough practice of the writing skill and failure to use sufficient additional resource materials.
c. Inadequate development of oral and reading skills which contribute to progress in writing.

How to solve Writing Problems

a. Prepare the learners thoroughly using the oral approach before giving them writing exercise to do on their own.
b. Give sufficient practice on the targeted writing skill before learners embark on the actual writing work. This involves use varied examples and additional resource materials such as visual aids.
c. In case of insufficient oral development in some pupils, the teacher can conduct remedial lessons by taking them through basic oral skills before writing.

Teaching Sequence for Writing Lesson

a. Oral presentation
    - Revise language work related to the writing exercise, for instance, through visual aids.
    - Revise relevant vocabulary or sentences.
    - Discuss with the pupils the work to be done.
    - Work out various examples orally
    - Write examples on the chalkboard.
b. Actual writing
    - Give clear instructions
    - Allow learners to write the work in their exercise books individually.
    - Assist individual pupils where necessary.
c. Conclusion
    - Mark a few books in class.
    - Do correction orally.
    - Write the answer on the chalkboard.

Purpose of Written Exercises as a Means of Reinforcing Oral Work and Reading

a. Filling in missing letters in words from a list of given letters or guided by pictures
Purpose:

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- Spelling
- Reinforcement of phonic rules
- Reinforcement of word formation

b. Matching words with pictures
Purpose:
- Vocabulary usage

c. Filling in missing words in sentences from a given list of words or guided by pictures, sentence context or words supplied.
Purpose:
- Sentence patterns/structures
- Vocabulary usage
- Reading
- Comprehension

d. Matching components of compound words
Purpose:
- Word formation

e. Matching questions with answers using picture clues or context clues guided by pictures or a reading text.
Purpose:
- Sentence structures
- Reading
- Comprehension

f. Matching beginning with endings of sentences using picture clues or reading text
Purpose:
- Sentence structures

g. Sentence completion
Purpose:
- Sentence structures

h. Writing plural of words and sentences
Purpose:
- Word forms

i. Writing opposite of words
Purpose:
- Vocabulary building
- Word formation

j. Making sentences from substitution tables
Purpose:
- Sentence structures

k. Arranging jumbled sentences in some order to form a continuous short paragraph
Purpose:
- Comprehension (based on reading text)
- Elementary composition writing

l. Writing parallel sentences
Purpose:
- Sentence structures

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Advantages of Written Exercises

a. They can be used to diagnose the ability of the learner.
b. Pupils learn to organize their written work which is important in composition writing.
c. Improves handwriting
d. Pupils master writing skills like correct spellings, punctuation and sentence structures.
e. Serves as a record for future reference.

How Written Exercises Have Been Misused

a. Failing to correct pupils' work promptly.
b. Pupils not doing the work on time
c. Pupils copying from one another
d. Teacher writing discouraging comments
e. Teacher using the exercise as a punishment.

Need for Guidance in Writing Lessons

A teacher should provide sufficient guidance to help learners reduce errors in writing. Errors in writing are difficult to mark and also so many correction red marks discourage learners. Guidance to learners should therefore be given in:

a. Content
b. Organization
c. Language

Types of Support/Guidance to be Given to Learners

a. Oral presentation for writing, for example, discussion and explanation.
b. Giving individual attention to pupils to enable them overcome their unique writing difficulties.
c. Providing pupils with key ideas or information needed such as picture clues or guiding questions.
d. Displaying a written model of the exercise for pupils to imitate.
e. Giving explanations on such skills as spelling and pronunciation.

Teaching English in Upper Primary

Objectives of Teaching English in Upper Primary

a. To enable learners communicate fluently, independently and accurately in everyday life.
b. To be used as a tool of teaching/learning other subjects.

Teaching Listening and Speaking Skills

I. Teaching Vocabulary

Here, we tackle mainly content words (verbs, nouns, adjectives, adverbs and some preposition).

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Criteria for Selection of Vocabulary

a. Pupils' familiarity with the word i.e. the teacher to start with the known words (vocabulary to do with things, people and actions within the immediate circumstance of the pupils) to the unknown.
b. Frequency of use in everyday life.
c. The level of difficulty
d. Appropriateness
e. Range

Techniques/Methods of Teaching Vocabulary

a. Direct vocabulary teaching method
   - Visual aids: real objects, pictures, photographs and drawings.
   - Demonstrations
   - Discussions
   - Explanations
   - Anecdotes
   - Description
b. Indirect vocabulary teaching method
   Here, pupils are allowed to deal with new lexical items without the teacher's intervention through:

   - Use of affixes (prefix and suffix)
     The students to first know the root word. Prefixes include: un- (undecided, unemployed, unnumbered), in- (inappropriate, indecisive, invalid), ir- (irregular, irresponsible, irrelevant), dis- (disenable, disfigure, disengage) etc.

     Suffixes include: -er (cleaner, teacher, preacher), -ness (darkness, faithfulness, happiness), -ful (faithful, mouthful), -ment (movement, management), -able (movable, readable).

   - Inferring meaning from context (contextualization)
     This can be a new word used in the passage but meaning can be inferred from the way it has been used. For instance: **deaf** – Tom could not hear the noise since he was deaf. **Dark** – the room was very **dark** so he could not find his pen.

   - Using the dictionary
     The learners must have the following skills before using the dictionary:

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- ✓ Finding one's way around the dictionary quickly using the alphabet.
- ✓ Selecting the correct word class for words with more than one function such as 'produce' as a noun and as a verb.
- ✓ Selecting the appropriate meaning of the word depending on the context.

- Phonic clues i.e. pupils using the sounds they already know for instance 'book' and 'cook' to help them pronounce the new ones like 'hook' and 'hood' correctly.
- Compounding i.e. pupils identifying meaning of new compound word like 'shopkeeper' or 'houseboy' if the two constituent parts are already known to the learners.
- Syllabification i.e. splitting a long word like 'germination' into parts like 'ger…mi…nation' before joining it together to enhance pronunciation.

NB: - The procedure for teaching new vocabulary items orally in upper primary remains the same as that of the lower primary from introduction, presentation, imitation, practice and reinforcement.

Written Vocabulary Exercises

a. Multiple choices
b. Filling in gaps in sentences, passages or dialogues.
c. Word-picture matching
d. Word-definition matching
e. Word building using prefixes and suffixes
f. Use of crossword puzzle

II. Teaching Sentence Patterns and Structures

Here, we mainly tackle structured words or functional words (auxiliary verbs, pronouns, determiners and conjunctions).

The Procedure for Teaching Sentence Patterns and Structure

a. Introduction

Use the new structure in meaningful context or a situation in the classroom that is familiar to the students, for instance, songs, poems, short narratives (anecdotes). You may also display visual aids like a picture or real object or use demonstration accompanied with questioning techniques.

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b. Presentation
Use the correct sentence structure in the context that brings out its meaning clearly then write on the chalkboard. Depending on the type of the sentence structure to be taught, use an appropriate technique for conveying the appropriate pattern like use of different examples, discussions, explanations, descriptions or pupils' general knowledge of the word.

c. Imitation
Provide the correct model with correct pronunciation, stress and intonation. Let students repeat orally your model either individually, or in pairs or in a group. Listen carefully as they say it and correct errors if any. Sentence patterns that prove to be persistently problematic should be isolated and practiced on their own. Make sure students do not just chant without understanding the appropriate sentence pattern.

d. Practice
Emphasize meaningful practice through continuous repetition of the sentence pattern in different situations. Practice new sentence structure through question and answer or instruction and response method as a group, in pairs or even individuals. However, the response from the learners must contain the new structure. You can use classroom situations or visual aids to accompany the practice activity. Emphasize on the following points:

- Thorough practice to be done i.e. each learner to get a chance to use the new structure either individually, in pairs or groups.
- Sufficient but meaningful examples beyond those in the course book to be provided even from familiar topics in other subjects.
- Both controlled and open activities to be provided ranging from guided to those creatively produced by the learners. Various methods of oral practice can be used here, for instance:
    - ✓ Chain drills i.e. each pupil speaking in turn to the next pupil as they stand in a circle.
    - ✓ Imitation Drill
      Let students repeat orally your sentence pattern either individually, or in pairs or in a group. Use the drill sufficiently so as the students become confident with the newly taught sentence patterns and structures.
    - ✓ Question and Answer Drill
      Ask a series of questions in a classroom situation or basing the question on the visual aids or contexts for enhancing the meaning of the pattern.

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- ✓ Substitution Drill
  Guide students construct sentences patterns similar to the ones taught.
  It involves one part of the previous sentence being changed each time.
- ✓ Pattern drills
- ✓ Language games
- ✓ Dialogues
- ✓ Use of songs

e. Reinforcement
Reinforce the newly taught pattern through:

- ✓ Reading passages and poems.
- ✓ Use written exercises
- ✓ Use art work such drawing

III. Teaching Grammar

<u>Grammatical Concepts Taught in Upper Primary</u>

a. Word classes (parts of speech) e.g.
   - Nouns
   - Pronouns
   - Verbs
   - Adjectives
   - Determiners
   - Prepositions
   - Conjunctions
b. Singular/Plural forms
c. Positive/negative forms
d. Tenses and their uses e.g.
   - Present simple tense
   - Present continuous tense
   - Present perfect continuous tense
   - Past simple tense
   - Past continuous tense
   - Past perfect continuous tense

NB: - The general approach of teaching grammar is the same as that of teaching new vocabulary. Examples to illustrate the concept are presented in the context of sentences, dialogue or anecdotes. During the presentation stage, the teacher should give explanations of meaning of concepts.

<u>Practicing Listening and Speaking Skills</u>

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Activities/Situations Used to Enhance Listening and Speaking Skills

1. Listening opportunities
   Listening to:

   a. Stories
   b. Speeches
   c. Songs and poems
   d. Debates
   e. Poems
   f. Plays
   g. Instructions & directions
   h. Radio programmes/films/announcements
2. Speaking opportunities
   a. Taking part in a conversation/dialogues
   b. Making interpretations
   c. Describing objects
   d. Giving directions/instructions
   e. Taking part in debates
   f. Acting plays
   g. Taking part in interviews
   h. Giving messages/reports
   i. Reciting poems
   j. Describing experience/events

Extended Oral Work Lessons

These are lessons that employ the use of activities or situations used to enhance listening and speaking skills above. They include: storytelling, drama, poetry, riddles, debating, speech-making and tongue twisters.

1. Story Telling
   This helps learners develop listening skills with the teacher assuming the role of a story teller. The teacher to enhance the learners' speaking skills and other language skills at the presentation stage through answering questions directed to them, repeating key lines and phrases and in the follow-up activities.

   Kinds of Stories
   a. Fables
   b. Legends
   c. Myths
   d. Human tales
   e. Ogre stories

   Sources of Stories to be Used in Class
   a. English versions of traditional stories

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b. Folk tales, fairy stories and fables from various parts of the world.
c. Children's stories in local newspapers and magazines e.g. Pied Crow, Rainbow.
d. Stories written by teachers on personal experiences, topical events or own imagination.
e. Published collections of children stories
f. Creative stories written by pupils.
g. Stories told by a resource person.
h. Stories told by pupils themselves.

Factors to Consider in Selecting a Story for Pupils

a. Should be the one that foster good attitudes in pupils.
b. Should have a limited number of characters i.e. few characters.
c. Should have a simple narrative structure/plot i.e. not too complex.
d. Should be one that has the language that is suitable for the learners i.e. language to be within their range.
e. Should have a moral lesson.
f. Should have content that is suitable for the learners' age and level of imagination.
g. Should have interesting ideas that are relevant to the learners' environment and experience.
h. Should be dramatic and exciting to the learners.
i. Should be short to suit the learners' span of attention.

NB: - Telling a story from memory is more effective than reading directly from a book because it becomes more interesting. On the other hand, reading a story directly is less interesting but it serves to remind pupils that there are interesting things in books.

How a Teacher Helps Learners in Preparing for Stories

a. Giving learners the beginning of a story to be completed.
b. Giving learners an outline of a complete story.
c. Providing a picture or series of picture to build a story from.
d. Helping learners to draw ideas from real events or personal experiences which can form a basis of a story.
e. Guiding learners in language use in the story i.e. providing lexical items and correcting mistakes done during the rehearsal (rehearsal to be done before story telling lesson)

NB: - The teacher basically helps the learners to prepare for story telling in terms of content, organization and language. This increases the learners' confidence and fluency. Note also that individual learners telling stories are only recommended from class six.

Importance /Advantage of Allowing Pupils Tell the Stories

a. Improves pupils' fluency in oral communication
b. Enhances organization of thought as pupils sequence ideas and events in their stories.
c. Gives information from the pupils' point of view.

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Importance / Advantages of a Teacher being a Storyteller

a. Provides a correct language model by providing correct pronunciations, stress and intonation patterns.
b. Provides explanations of any difficult words to aid pupils' understanding.
c. Uses varied story telling techniques which makes the story very interesting.
d. Can elicit learner

Story Telling Techniques

a. Use of *tonal or voice variation* to represent different characters and emotions. For instance, deep and soft voice for different characters and varying of voice quality, pitch and volume to express different emotions like fear, anger or tiredness.
b. Use of *gestures*, *facial expressions* and *miming* to reinforce meaning.
c. Use of visual aids .e.g. pictures and objects.
d. Initiating audience (learners or pupils) participation through:
    i. Repeating key phrases, lines or sentences in the story.
    ii. Answering questions asked by characters in the story.
    iii. Anticipating what is going to happen next.
    iv. Singing songs contained in the story.
    v. Creating appropriate sound effects .e.g. idiophones and onomatopoeia.

Lesson Procedure for a Story Telling Lesson

a. Language preparation
   Teach the new vocabulary or lexical items found in the story in order to enhance comprehension during narration.
b. Introduction to the story
   Stimulate the pupils' interest in the story by:
    i. Discussing the visual aids and situational context based on the story.
    ii. Linking the story with the pupil's environment and experiences.
    iii. Discussing the title of the story through question and answer technique.
c. Narration
   Narrate the stories making it as interesting as possible using the story telling techniques (tonal variation, facial expressions, gestures, miming, mimicry, body movements and initiating learner participation through repetition of main phrases and singing)
d. Checking understanding
   Ask oral questions based on the story.
e. Follow-up activities
   These are meant to enhance understanding and memory. They include:
    i. Discussing of themes and characters in the story.
    ii. Dramatization of parts or the whole story.
    iii. Singing any song contained in the story.
    iv. Artwork .e.g. drawing, painting or cartoon work.
    v. Modeling characters using clay or plasticine.
    vi. Making puppets and masks.

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vii. Written exercises .i.e. composition writing, dialogue based on the story, summary of the story or describing characters in the story in written form.

Teaching/Learning Aids Suitable for Storytelling Lesson

a. Puppets such as marionettes.
b. Chalkboard drawings and sketches
c. Flannel graph
d. Real objects
e. Picture sequences or series
f. Models
g. Pictures in the course books
h. Box television (toy)

Importance / Advantages of Story Telling Lessons

a. Pupils learn and practice language in an enjoyable way.
b. Provides pupils with an opportunity to develop their listening and speaking skills as they listen to and practice telling stories.
c. The teacher can use them to introduce and present new language items.
d. The stories can be used to teach morals, for instance, where the good is rewarded and evil punished.
e. They can be used to inform thus widening the scope of knowledge of the pupils.
f. They help to stimulate the pupils' imagination that is later needed in creative writing.
g. They help teach about culture and history.
h. Used to raise and discuss current issues like HIV/AIDS, violence against women, environmental degradation etc.
i. Help in moulding character as some learners will tend to identify themselves with certain characters in the stories such heroes and heroines.

2. Drama Lessons

Drama is one of the genres of literature that is imaginative or a creative reproduction mainly for the purpose of performance before an audience .i.e. a staged art.

Forms of Classroom Drama / Drama Activities

a. Dialogues / Conversations

Dialogue is "a conversation between two persons." A dialogue is a discourse that involves two or more interlocutors. The roots of the word 'dialogue' can be traced to the Greek "dia" and "logos" which means "through meaning." Conversation simply refers to the use of speech for exchange of ideas by two or more people.

Dialogues and conversations are used for practice of specific language items. The teacher should put speech in context and allow pupils see how speech is used in a particular context or situation. Say the dialogue first before allowing learners to participate. Introduce pairs or group work where the dialogues and conversations can be acted rather than just spoken.

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b. Improvised dramatization / Spontaneous acting
This is a natural reaction to a particular situation .i.e. an unplanned dramatization usually based on reading passages or stories to enhance comprehension. This is usually done as a follow-up activity.

c. Role playing
This is used to develop practical speech skills. Here, pupils are asked to: take part in interviews, give messages, give directions, act as interpreters, role play as doctor and patient or teacher and student.

d. Scripted Playlets /Dramatic Excerpts
These are used as reading texts. They can be acted in a formal way. Pupils may read as they act or memorize their speech before acting.

Procedure for Teaching a Play

a. Oral Preparation
Discuss with the pupils the topic, the characters or pictures if any.

b. Presentation
Read the first scene aloud and clearly. Ask learners to read silently to extract the main points about the characters and events. Ask simple oral questions on each scene so as to bring out main points.

c. Reading aloud by pupils
Allow pupils to take part in the play and read aloud as you guide them in expression.

d. Discussing questions related to the play.
Do a critical analysis of the play as you discuss with the learners questions related to the play.

Advantages of Drama Lessons

a. Develops oral skills (listening and speaking)
b. Develops and improves the memory skills.
c. Pupils develop self confidence in the use of English as they put into practice already-learnt sentence structures and vocabulary.
d. Provides an opportunity for pupils to exploit their talents and creativity.
e. Develops pupils' imagination and creativity.

3. Poetry Lessons
Introduce poetry with rhythm and rhyme in standard one.
Criteria for Selecting Poems to Use in Class

a. The topic should be relevant and related to the learners' environment, interest and experience.
b. They should have narrative and dramatic elements.
c. They should have rhythm and sound devises like idiophones, onomatopoeia, alliteration and rhyme.
d. They should be those that foster positive attitude.
e. They should have language that is at the pupils' level of ability, imagination and age.
f. They should contain current and emerging issues like women empowerment, children rights, HIV/AIDS or governance.

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Procedure for Conducting a Poetry Lesson

a. Introduction
   Do oral preparation and motivation .i.e. teach and revise new language items and sentence patterns in terms of pronunciation, stress, intonation and meaning coupled with a discussion on visual aids like pictures based on the poem. Also do a brief and general discussion on the topic and theme through the question and answer technique.
b. Presentation
   Read and recite the poem aloud with the correct pronunciation, stress and intonation putting emphasis on rhythm and sound devices (idiophones, onomatopoeia, alliteration and rhyme) if any as the learners listen. Use story telling techniques like miming, mimicry, gestures, facial expressions and voice variation to accompany your recitation.
c. Imitation
   Allow learners to recite the poem aloud by copying your model first as a whole class then in pairs or groups (choral performance) or individually or both.
d. Discussion
   Do a specific and comprehensive discussion of the themes to enhance comprehension of the content.
e. Checking understanding
   Ask oral questions based on the poem to assess whether the pupils have understood the poem or not.
f. Follow-up activities
   Have activities that will enhance understanding and memory like:
   i. Dramatization of narrative poems.
   ii. Memorization and recitation either individually or choral performance
   iii. Art works like modeling, drawing and painting.
   iv. Written exercises
   v. Writing or copying down the poem.
   vi. Creative writing

Advantage of Poetry Lessons

a. Arouse pupils' interest and imagination by providing a variation in teaching methods.
b. Develops and improves the learners' oral skills (listening and speaking) .e.g. pronunciation, stress and intonation.
c. Develops learners' self confidence in expression using English language.
d. Poetry can be used to introduce, practice and revise new language items and sentence patterns.
e. Develops the coordination of speech or music with actions.
f. Develops and improves memory skills.

4. Audiovisual Programmes (Radio Lessons)

Preparation for Radio Lessons

a. Study the content to be covered during the radio lesson.
b. Prepare an introduction and follow-up activities like written exercises.
c. Collect visual aids.

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d. Write the new words or sentence structures on the chalkboard
e. Carry out a revision of the sentence structures.

Teacher Activities during Radio Lesson Broadcast
a. Listen carefully and make notes for follow up and discussion.
b. Give instructions such as the right page in the pupils' course books.
c. Provide leading cues so that pupils respond to the teacher.
d. Indicate the correct answer after the pupils have attempted answering the questions asked by the radio teacher.
e. Make use of the chalkboard as directed by the radio teacher.

Advantages of Radio Lessons
a. They are usually interesting.
b. They provide a variation from the normal classroom method of teaching.
c. They provide an opportunity for pupils to listen to accurate articulation (pronunciation, stress and intonation) of English words.
d. One lesson can be used for many learners.
e. Learners get highly organized content as the lessons are thoroughly prepared.

Disadvantages of Radio Lessons
a. Lack of feedback between the teacher and the pupils.
b. Various conditions like electric fault or technical problems may hinder its success.
c. Lack of technical know-how to operate the radio may hinder its progress.
d. It may be costly to some institutions in terms of electricity installation and where and expert to operate it is to be hired.

Teaching Reading in Upper Primary

Importance / Advantage of Reading
a. For education / learning reasons or didactic value – Pupils are able to access written information and understand written instructions through reading during learning and examination.
b. Used as a source of pleasure or entertainment .e.g. reading a novel at free time for adventure.
c. Used for survival reasons .e.g. in the interpretation of traffic lights and public notices.

Purposes of Reading Lessons
a. To develop skills for accurate reading.
b. To develop skills for independent reading.
c. To develop skills for making inferences, deductions and conclusions.
d. To gather information.

Reading Skills
a. Word recognition
This is the ability to recognize instantly the written form of familiar words and their meaning.
b. Understanding basic and exact meaning of different types of sentences.

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c. Relating the text to pictures, diagrams, charts and maps.
d. Understanding passage coherence .i.e. ways in which sentences and ideas in a sentence are linked or related in a passage.
e. Understanding hidden or implied meaning in a passage.
f. Understanding different formats used in different functional writings.
g. Relating the text to personal experience.
h. Using reference or special reading skills:
   i. Dictionary skill.
      Importance of Dictionary Skills
      They help the leaner to:
      - Check the meaning of words and phrases through:
        - ✓ Finding the headword using knowledge of the alphabetical order.
        - ✓ Choosing the meaning which fits the context.
        - ✓ Understanding words formed using the headwords and their part of speech .e.g. kind – kindness, move – movable.
        - ✓ Understanding idiomatic expressions.
      - Check spellings of words
      - Check pronunciation of words
      - Check stress and intonation in words.
   ii. Skimming – Reading a book or a text rapidly for general information .i.e. reading through a text to get an idea of what it is all about .e.g. by looking at table of content, titles or headings, subheadings, topic sentences of each paragraph, pictures and their captions, blurbs and synopsis.
      Importance of Skimming
      - Helps the reader to decide whether to read the whole text or not.
      - Helps the reader to understand the text better if he/she decides to read it as he/she has prior idea of how the text is organized.
   iii. Scanning – Reading for specific information.
      Uses of Scanning
      - To get information from notices, passages, posters, advertisements or timetables
      - To find entries in dictionaries, directories or encyclopedia.
   iv. Critical reading – Reading carefully for detailed meaning and critical analysis .e.g. analysis of set texts.

Modes of Teaching Reading in Upper Primary

1. Silent Reading
   This is where pupils read without producing sound of what they are reading. It is dominantly used in upper primary. It is a faster mode of reading and improves comprehension as pupils are able to concentrate on the text. It also encourages independence reading and pupils develop accuracy and confidence in reading.

   Obstacles / Problems to Silent Reading
   a. Noise
   b. Poor visual skills
   c. Poor sound discrimination skill

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d. Mental immaturity

Solutions to Silent Reading Problems
a. Ensure that pupils read in a noise-free area.
b. Improve the visual skills of the pupils like having them differentiate shapes or letters.
c. Re-teach phonic skills
d. Have pupils practice reading aloud before asking them to read silently.

2. Reading Aloud
This is reading as the learners produce vocal sound of what they are reading.
Occasionally, the teacher in upper primary can use it to:
a. Test the learner's accuracy, fluency and ability to read.
b. Correct the pupil's pronunciation, stress and intonation.

Disadvantages of Reading Aloud
a. Pupils are more concerned with pronunciation than with understanding the text.
b. It is difficult to know if the learner has understood the text or not.
c. Slows the pace of reading.
d. Most learners in the class are passive listeners as one pupil reads aloud.
e. Does not encourage independence reading.

Comparison between Silent Reading and Reading Aloud

Silent Reading	**Reading Aloud**
Reading speed is faster	Reading speed is slow because there is diverted attention.
Comprehension is easier as pupils are able to concentrate on the text.	Comprehension is difficult for the learner due to lack of concentration.
Encourages independence reading.	Does not encourage independence reading
Pupils develop accuracy and confidence in reading.	Pupils may not develop confidence in reading.

Methods / Types of Teaching Reading in Upper Primary
1. Intensive Reading
Reading for comprehension or to get detailed meaning of a text (passage or short story) .i.e. the reader pays attention to every phrase for understanding.

Criteria for Selecting a Reading Text for Intensive Reading
a. It should have interesting themes.
b. It should have new language items to be taught.
c. It should be of a reasonable length .i.e. not too long.

Procedure for an Intensive Reading Lesson
a. Language Preparation
Do an oral introduction by practicing the new lexical items and sentence structures.
Revise the previously taught words that are important to the text if any.
b. Motivation for Reading

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Briefly discuss the theme and topic of the text by linking it to the learners' environment and experience. Discuss the visual aids like pictures or real objects if any. Read the first paragraph aloud to motivate the pupils.

c. Silent Reading
Allow pupils to read the text silently and independently for speed, fluency and comprehension. Correct bad reading habits like regression (backtracking), head movements, lip movements and finger pointing as they read.

d. Checking Understanding
Assess the learner's general understanding and comprehension of the text through oral questions based on the text. Remember to vary the oral questions .i.e. vary the question content, question form and question procedure.

e. Follow-up Activities
These are activities meant to enhance understanding of the text like:
- Dramatization
- Role play
- Discussion
- Written work like written questions, summary or essay writing. With written questions remember to vary the questions .i.e. vary the question content, question form and question procedure.

<u>Methods of Varying Questions in an Intensive Reading Lesson</u>

a. Question content
Questions may focus on different aspects thus testing the learners' ability to:
- Recall information from the text.
- Explain direct meaning of language items and sentence.
- Explain implied meaning of language items and sentence as used in the text (context)
- Make deductions
- Relate information in the text to their own experience.
- Understand the flow of events in the text.

b. Question form
Questions may be framed in various ways like:
- Open-ended questions .i.e. questions that are answered with word phrases or sentences and are not limited to the text.
- Multiple-choice questions .i.e. questions that do not require productive skills .e.g. TRUE/FALSE questions, choosing the best answer out of various options and YES/NO questions.
- Questions requiring non-verbal responses .e.g. drawing something mentioned in the text, completing a map or a diagram or a table based on the text read.

c. Question procedure
This is the way administering questions like:
- Oral questions asked by individuals to their classmates.
- Written questions for individuals or groups.
- Simple oral questions after first reading.
- Group discussion of multiple-choice questions.

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- Open-ended questions answered by the whole class or a group.

Bad Reading Habits and Remedial Actions

a. Finger pointing
   Remedy: Improve visual memory and skills of the pupil using pictures.
b. Vocalizing
   Remedy: Use phonic skills to re-teach reading.
c. Poor body posture
   Remedy: improve quality of seats and distance from reading material. Advise on proper seating arrangements and posture.
d. Backtracking (reading the same sentence more than once)
   Remedy: Practise pronouncing words and reading sentences.
e. Lip movement
   Remedy: Provide more reading materials to enhance confidence. Advise practicing silent reading.
f. Head movement
   Remedy: Advise on the movement of the eyes not the head.

Ways through which a Teacher can Encourage Pupils to Read

a. Keeping a reading chart for all pupils.
b. Using resource persons to read to the pupils.
c. Rewarding the best pupils in reading .e.g. verbal approval, material incentives or clapping for them.
d. Assigning materials to be used in reading .e.g. course books and set a quiz on it.
e. Asking pupils to give oral report on what they have read.
f. Reading to the pupils the way you would like them to read.
g. Setting aside a specific time in a week to be used for reading in class.
h. Keeping clear reading to assess their reading progress and to track the reading they have done.
i. Arranging for pupils to get daily newspapers to read.

Problems that Lead to Reading Retardation in Pupils and their Solutions (Remedies)

Problem	**Solution**
Inadequate or lack of oral competence.	Use teaching aid .e.g. pictures or real objects.
Poorly developed phonic skills.	Use lower primary reading methods to re-teach phonic skills .e.g. missing letter exercises & creating a phonic corner.
Poorly developed word attack skills.	Re-teach word attack skills like use of picture clues, context clues, analyzing compound words & use of affixes. Also maximize English language exposure to the learner .e.g. by avoiding mother tongue in class.
Environmental problems like poor home background.	Visit the pupil's home and talk to the parents.
Mental and physical problems like	Contact a medical practitioner.

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poor eyesight.	
Inadequate practice in word recognition.	Provide a variety of reading materials. Encourage parents to provide sufficient reading material to their children.
Developmental problems.	Be patient with the slow learners. Give them remedial work either individually, in pairs or groups. Provide simpler reading materials. Maintain a clear reading progress record of the learners.

2. Extensive Reading
   This is reading widely beyond the limits of prescribed course books for pleasure or enjoyment. The pupil gets the opportunity to read beyond the English course books.

   Advantages of Extensive Reading
   a. Pupils get an opportunity to practice reading skills learnt during intensive reading lesson.
   b. Pupils get an opportunity to develop silent reading skills .e.g. ability to concentrate.
   c. Pupils widen their general world scope of knowledge.
   d. Pupils widen their range of vocabulary and sentence patterns.
   e. Pupils practise and improve their reading speed, pronunciation and fluency.
   f. Pupils derive satisfaction from the freedom of reading independently.
   g. Pupils benefit from the general knowledge of education .i.e. they gain information.
   h. Pupils read to enrich memory and gain pleasure.
   i. Provides pupils with situations in which learning takes place.
   j. Provides pupils with situations that expose them to direct experience of language as used in real life.
   k. Pupils can develop their individual interest and thus develop a positive attitude towards reading.

   Disadvantages of Confining Pupils to only the English Course Books
   a. Prevents the pupil to discover the enjoyment that is in reading.
   b. Limits the pupils' outlook by not allowing them to come into contact with the wider world of interest and information contained in other books.
   c. Retards the development of the pupils' ability to read and understand.

   Ways through which a Teacher can Encourage Pupils to Read Extensively
   a. Asking pupils about their reading and praising them when they venture into more difficult books.
   b. Suggesting particular books to individual pupils.
   c. Showing learners that you read extensively and you enjoy doing so.
   d. Making suitable books available for the learners.

   Ways of Developing Extensive Reading Skills

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These ways are aimed at practising the skills taught in intensive reading (comprehension reading). They include:

a. Understanding cohesion in a text.
b. Making a critical analysis and judgement of a text author or writer.
c. Predicting what is likely to happen.
d. Accumulating, sorting and storing information.
e. Understanding the implication of an event or a series of events.
f. Working out the contextual meaning of words and use of unfamiliar words and language patterns.
g. Identifying the main theme of a chapter or a book as a whole.

Library Lesson

This is an example of an extensive reading lesson. Pupils read books in class and school library.

Criteria for Selecting Class Library Materials

a. Should have content that is interesting to all students .e.g. comedies, tragedies, tragic-comedies, satires, romance, careers, family life, heroism, hobbies or history.
b. Should be in tandem with the national goals for education.
c. Should be of reasonable length .i.e. not too long.
d. Should create balance between fictional and factual (non-fictional) texts.
e. Should have language level (vocabulary and sentence patterns) that is within the range of the learners.
f. Should be durable.
g. Should have appropriate print size.
h. Should have sufficient illustrations in form of well-drawn pictures, diagrams or tables.
i. Should be attractive .i.e. have a colourful and appealing cover page.
j. Affordable in terms of the cost of the book.

Materials to be Found in a Class Library

a. Dictionaries, directories and encyclopedias.
b. Reference materials / books like guide books.
c. Children's magazines such Rainbow and Pied Crow.
d. Course books.
e. Readers in the language of the catchment area.
f. Readers in the required or taught languages.
g. Atlases.
h. Teachers' own collection of materials written by either the pupils or the teacher or both.

Skills to be Developed in the Library Lesson

a. Skimming – Reading or surveying a text or book for general information .i.e. reading through a text to get an idea of what it is all about .e.g. by looking at table of content, titles or headings, subheadings, topic sentences of each paragraph, pictures and their

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captions, blurbs and synopsis. This is basically to help the reader to decide whether to read the whole text or not.

b. Rapid reading techniques .e.g. avoiding backtracking.
c. The care of books .e.g. not folding pages.
d. Remembering the gist of what has been read.

Improvised Reading Materials

a. Printed materials .e.g. children's magazine.
b. Handwritten and typed materials .e.g. stories written by teachers or older pupils.
c. Old books.
d. Newspaper cut-outs with interesting articles.

Procedure for Conducting an Extensive Reading Lesson (Library Lesson)

a. Language Preparation
    - Ensure every learner has a specific reading objective .e.g. speed, fluency, pronunciation of sounds or words, comprehension or reading a specified length like two chapters and answering questions.
    - Help learners choose appropriate reading material from what is available.
b. Motivation for Reading
    Arouse the pupils' interest in reading materials for example by reading short extracts or episodes from books, watching and listening to some recorded/taped short extracts or episodes from the materials, giving brief summary of books/materials or discussion of some interesting episodes from the materials.
c. Silent Reading
    - Allow pupils to read the text silently and independently for speed, fluency and comprehension as they identify and list new language items and write text summaries or do any other activity that may be necessary.
    - Correct bad reading habits like regression (backtracking), body posture, vocalization, head movements, lip movements and finger pointing as they read.
    - Encourage learners to read faster and avoid habits that may slow them down in reading .e.g. encourage them to make intelligent contextual meanings of new words rather than stopping every time to refer to the dictionary while reading.
    - Give help on difficult vocabulary .e.g. in pronunciation or meaning.
    - In case of a remedial group (slow or poor readers), attend to them promptly.
d. Checking Understanding
    Ask oral questions based on the read texts.
e. Follow-up activities
    To enhance understanding, comprehension and memory, you may do the following:
    - Discussion on the read text.
    - Explanation of difficult words.
    - Written exercises .e.g. writing summary of the texts.
    - Dramatization based on text.
    - Role play based on the text.

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NOTE:
At the end of an extensive reading lesson (library lesson), the teacher should:
a. Update library records.
b. Update individual class reading records using reading cards, wall charts or pages of a book noting individual reading attainment so as to gauge improvement among the pupils.

Fluent Reading
This is the ability to read smoothly and accurately.
Advantages of Fluent Reading
a. Increases reading speed.
b. Makes it easy to deal with long texts.
c. Improves the learning pace.
d. One is encouraged to read more texts and with a better understanding.
e. Pupils gain information and widen their knowledge.
f. Expands vocabulary as one reads many reading materials.

Teaching Writing in Upper Primary
Writing is the ability to communicate ideas, opinion, instructions or any information through print, signs and symbols. The specific objective of teaching writing is that, ***"Pupils should be able to express themselves legibly in written English using appropriate punctuations, spelling, grammar and vocabulary."*** This can be achieved when learners are involved in: expressing their feelings and opinions, giving information in written form and giving instructions and directions.

Writing Sub-Skills and Activities/Exercises Used to Reinforce/Develop them
a. Handwriting
Activities:
- Copying individual letters severally in the book.
- Re-writing single words or sentences or paragraphs.

b. Vocabulary
Activities:
- Filling in missing words in sentences or paragraphs.
- Constructing sentences using given words.
- Matching words with pictures.
- Filling in crossword puzzles.
- Writing the opposite of words.

c. Spelling and word formation
Activities:
- Writing plurals of words.
- Arranging letters to form words.
- Filling in missing letters in words.
- Matching components of compound words (compounding).
- Adding affixes (prefixes and suffixes) to words.
- Writing words from dictation.
- Writing opposites of words.

d. Grammar .e.g. word classes, tenses, singular and plurals.

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Activities:

- Gap filling exercises.
- Paragraph writing.
- Composition writing.
- Matching exercises

e. Punctuation .i.e. capital letters, full stops, speech marks, exclamation marks, apostrophes, hyphens, dashes, colons, semicolons, commas, ellipsis, and question marks.
Activities:
- Punctuating unpunctuated sentence or paragraph.
- Punctuating sentences or paragraphs from dictation.
- Capitalizing proper nouns and at sentence initial.
- Adding questions tags to statements.

f. Sentence construction / patterns
Activities:
- Filling in missing words.
- Matching question with answers.
- Matching beginning with ending of sentences
- Sentence completion.
- Making sentences from substitution tables.
- Writing parallel sentences.
- Arranging given words to form sentences.
- Joining sentences using conjunctions.
- Adding questions tags to statements.

g. Choice, length and organization of content
Activities:
- Arranging jumbled sentences to form a coherent paragraph.
- Note making.
- Summary writing.

h. Format and layout of various types of functional writing and continuous writing.
Activities:
- Arranging jumbled sentences to form a coherent paragraph.
- Note making.
- Summary writing.
- Diary writing.
- Letter writing.
- Composition (essay writing)

Teaching Procedure for Written Exercises

a. Introduction
Revise previous language work (vocabulary and sentence patterns) related to the writing exercise, for instance, through relevant visual aids (pictures and real objects) or flashcards.

b. Oral Preparation
- Carefully explain and expand the topic by working out various examples orally.
- Write examples on the chalkboard.

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- Give clear instructions to the learners.

c. Individual Writing
   - Allow learners to write the work in their exercise books individually.
   - Assist individual weak pupils where necessary.

d. Follow-up Activities
   - Mark a few books in class.
   - Do correction orally.
   - Write the answer on the chalkboard
   - If the work is incomplete, ask the learners to do the remaining work as homework.

Continuous Writing

Types of Continuous Writing/Compositions

a. Guided Writing

This is where the teacher largely directs the pupils by helping them with content, language and organization (format) of materials.

Types of Guided Compositions

- Writing from brief notes

  The teacher provides notes from which learners write a composition by adding their own ideas, for instance:

  Topic: Describe your School
  - ✓ Well organized classroom.
  - ✓ A very beautiful landscape.
  - ✓ Classes begin very early in the morning.
  - ✓ Teachers are punctual to classes.
  - ✓ High education standards.
  - ✓ Discipline is very high.
  - ✓ Good rapport between teachers and students.
  - ✓ I like it very much.
- Arranging jumbled up sentences in a sequence to form a continuous paragraph or story, for instance:
  - ✓ Now we are very good friends.
  - ✓ He seemed arrogant and unkind.
  - ✓ I changed my mind when I got to know him better.
  - ✓ When I first met Tom, I didn't like him.

  Answer:

  When I first met Tom, I didn't like him. He seemed arrogant and unkind. I changed my mind when I got to know him better. Now we are very good friends.
- Frame composition (Gap-filling type of composition), for instance:

  I……..up very early in the morning. I……my teeth before……breakfast. My mum pays for my…….fare daily to school. She…….me very much. I too……her.
- Giving answers to a series of questions which can be used to build up a story or a paragraph. For instance:

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Topic: My Daily Activities

Question	Answer (paragraph of story)
At what time do you wake up?	I wake up at six o'clock in the morning
What do you do after waking up?	After waking up, brush my teeth and take a bath.
What do you take for breakfast?	I take tea for breakfast.
What do you do next?	I go to school.

- Writing paragraphs from substitution tables, for instance:
- Developing topic sentences provided by the teacher.
- Pictorial composition

b. Open-ended (free) writing .i.e. developing a composition from a given topic.
It tests on the individual creativity of the learner. For example:
- Writing on a given topic .e.g. 'My Best Friend.'
- Letter writing .e.g. 'Write a letter to your friend in USA'
- Writing something for the class or school magazine.
- Completing a story from a given beginning or ending.
- Writing on various activities .e.g. a recently concluded football competition.

c. Dramatic conversations or dialogues
The learner is expected to come up with a conversation that obeys the register (language according to use) selected .i.e. in terms mode and field of discourse, social differences, relationship between the speaker and the listener and degree of formality.

Factors to Consider in Selecting a Topic for Continuous Writing Lesson

a. Suitability
It should be relevant and suitable to the learners' imagination, experience, age and environment.

b. Type of writing
The type writing to be taught .e.g. dialogues, letters, diaries or free writing should be varied according to the syllabus and emphasis put to where learners have more problems.

c. Language level
It should be a topic that requires language items (vocabulary and sentence patterns) that are within the range of the learners' competence.

Conducting a Continuous Writing Lesson

a. Introduction
- Revise previous language work (vocabulary and sentence patterns) related to the writing exercise, for instance, through relevant visual aids (pictures and real objects) or flashcards.
- Generally discuss the topic by relating it to the learners' experience in a way that stimulates their thinking.

b. Oral Preparation
- Assist learners build up ideas and information orally .e.g. through asking leading questions.

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- Write the ideas and information in a sequential manner on the chalkboard as you expound or add more details on them.
- Explain and guide the learners in terms of organization (sentences into paragraphs and their cohesion), format and language (vocabulary, sentence patterns and degree of formality)

c. Individual Writing
- Allow learners to write the work in their exercise books individually.
- Assist individual weak pupils where necessary.
- Remind the pupils to proofread their work before handing it in for marking.

d. Marking
- Mark a few books in class and collect the rest.

e. Follow-up Activities
- Do corrections promptly .e.g. by giving clear instructions as to whether the pupils should correct the pieces of work, whole sentences or individual words.
- Give remedial work if most pupils display a common difficulty.
- Read out best compositions to class or display them on the wall to motivate the learners.

<u>How a Teacher Helps Individual Pupils during Writing</u>

a. Checking the plan and correcting where necessary.
b. Suggesting content if the learner runs out of ideas.
c. Give assistance with vocabulary and spellings.
d. Pointing out careless mistakes.
e. Advising on the need for a legible and regular handwriting.

<u>Marking and Correcting the Pupils' Continuous Writing Work</u>

During real marking the teacher should:

a. Correct errors and mistakes or select those that could have been avoided. Remember that correct each and every single mistake may cause so many red marks on the pupils' work which might discourage them.
b. Provide information about the type of error and mistake by:
   - Underlining the error and writing the correct version.
   - Underlining the error and then using a symbol to indicate its type .e.g.
     - ✓ SP – Spelling.
     - ✓ T – Tense
     - ✓ P – Punctuation error
     - ✓ W – Wrong word used
     - ✓ Wo – Wrong word order
     - ✓ Gr – Grammar error
     - ✓ ∧ – Omission of .e.g. word.
     - ✓ ? – What do you mean?
     - ✓ ┌ – Start a new paragraph
     - ✓ √ – A good point.

     NB: - Make sure your learners are familiar to the symbols before using them.
   - Underlining the error or indicating its location without identifying its type.

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c. Have a general marking scheme that has particular aspects to look at so that it guides you marking for an objective marking .e.g.:

• Relevance to the topic	–	10
• Organization of the material	–	8
• Variety of vocabulary and sentence structures	–	6
• Grammar	–	6
• Punctuation, spelling and capitalization	–	4
• Creativity	–	2
• Neat and legible handwriting	–	2
• Ease of communication and originality	–	2
Total	–	40%

d. Develop a positive attitude to writing in pupils .i.e. let them know that you care about their writing through:
   - Writing appreciative comments in the margin and at the end of the work.
   - Making a positive suggestion for improvement.

After marking and returning the composition to the learners the teacher should do the following as follow-up activities:

a. Reinforce, remind, and sensitise the pupils on the importance of:
   - Proofreading their work before handing it in.
   - Using legible handwriting.
b. Read aloud well written compositions in class or even pin them on the notice-board for all students to see so as to develop a positive attitude to writing in pupils.
c. Do corrections promptly .e.g. by giving clear instructions as to whether the pupils should correct the pieces of work, whole sentences or individual words.
d. Give remedial work if most pupils display a common difficulty.

<u>Aspects that a Teacher should strive to Achieve in a Given Writing Skill</u>

A teacher can base on this while making a marking scheme for continuous writing.

a. Vocabulary
   - Exhibiting an extensive vocabulary .i.e. ability to use a variety of vocabulary.
   - Using vocabulary correctly.
   - Spelling words correctly.
b. Sentence structures
   - Arranging the written work into sentences
   - Making correct usage of syntax and grammar.
   - Punctuating the sentences correctly.
c. Paragraph structures
   - Designing a paragraph to contain one main idea.
   - Arranging sentences within it in a suitable order.
   - Making use of topic sentence.
d. Composition structure
   - Planning the composition properly.
   - Arranging paragraphs in a logical manner.
   - Using the paragraphs to develop the ideas.

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e. Content
    - Ensuring that content is relevant to the title
    - Displaying originality and creativity.
    - Supplying accurate information.

EVALUATING LANGUAGE SKILLS

Evaluation is a systematic determination or assessment of a subject's merit, worth and significance, using a criteria governed by a set of standards. In a school context, to ensure that both short-term and long-term objectives of the course are achieved, evaluation is normally done.

Reasons for Evaluating Pupils

a. Enables the teacher to diagnose and know their pupils ability, weakness and progress in language learning.
b. Enables the teacher in checking whether the objectives were achieved or not.
c. Enables the teacher to evaluate their teaching methods and change where necessary to aid pupils' understanding.
d. Helps the teacher to identify those pupils who need extra help so that they can be given remedial teaching.
e. Helps the examining bodies like Kenya National Examination Council (KNEC) to find out whether work covered was well understood by pupils in terms of content and skills given in the syllabus.
f. Helps the pupils understand their mistakes from the corrections done and put more effort where necessary.
g. Encourages pupils to revise their work and to ask questions in areas they did not understand because they know they will be assessed.
h. The results are used for certification .e.g. at the end of the course.
i. Motivates pupils to learn and appreciate the importance of being in school.
j. Helps a new teacher to:
    - Identify how much work was covered by the previous teacher.
    - Identify whether the work covered was understood by the pupils or may need re-teaching or remedial work.
    - Find out how effective the teaching was.
    - Identify the strong and weak pupils for the purposes of grouping them.

Types of Evaluation / Assessment Procedures

a. Day-to-day evaluation .i.e. short tests, quizzes or assignments that monitor learning daily focusing on specific objectives within the syllabus. It otherwise referred to as formative evaluation in psychology.

    Importance of Day-to-Day Evaluation
    - Helps the teacher to decide whether to move to the next content or to re-teach the previous content to specific individuals, groups or the whole class.
    - They form a basis for the aspects to be tested in final examination.

b. Broad-based evaluation .i.e. tests and examination that evaluate learning of an extended period of time .e.g. a fortnight, a month, a term, a year or end of the full course. It otherwise referred to as summative evaluation in psychology.

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Importance of Broad-based Evaluation

They help the teacher to:

- Identify the different abilities in pupils.
- Decide whether to promote a pupil to the next class or not.
- Gauge the pupils' understanding of the syllabus.

Constructing Test Items

Factors to Consider in Setting English Tests / Content of English Questions

a. Teacher should first know what to set before deciding how to set it.
b. Decide on the language items to be tested .i.e. sounds, vocabulary and sentence patterns.
c. Decide on the language skills to be tested .i.e. listening, speaking, reading or writing skills.
d. The test items should correspond with what has been taught.
e. Decide on different question type to use .e.g. open-ended, multiple choices from various options given, yes-no questions, gap filling, true-false questions, arranging jumbled up sentences etc.

Qualities of a Good Test

a. Validity
   It should be accurate in measuring what it targets to test in terms of content and skill.
b. Reliability
   It should be consistent and dependable .i.e. if the same learner is given the same test many times under similar circumstances, he/she should be able to obtain same scores.

Features / Characteristics of a Good Test

a. Each question aims at testing a particular language skill although their respective sub-skills can also be tested .e.g. in writing, handwriting, spellings, punctuation, vocabulary or grammar can be tested. While in reading, skimming or critical reading can be tested.
b. Has clear instructions and language used is not ambiguous.
c. Questions set have only one correct answer especially in multiple choice questions.
d. The alternatives or distractors to multiple choice questions are carefully selected so that the pupil is challenged when picking out the correct answer.

Types of Tests

a. Multiple choice tests
   It is where learners are allowed to select an option from various options given or yes-no questions or true-false questions.

   Advantage of Multiple Choice Tests

   - It can be used to test many language items (vocabulary, sentence patterns) at the same time.
   - There is no doubt of the answer especially where the teacher has made sure that only one alternative is the correct answer.
   - Each item can deal with a particular problem.
   - Marking is easy and accurate.

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Disadvantage of Multiple Choice Tests

- It cannot be used to test certain skills like speaking, creative writing and handwriting.
- It can encourage guesswork among pupils.

Factors to Consider While Setting a Multiple Choice Test

- Each test item should have the stem (main part of the question), the key (correct answer) and distractors (wrong alternatives).
- There should be a number of distractors.
- There should be only one key.
- The distractors should be close to the correct answer (key).
- The key should not stand out or easy to indentify .e.g. by being longer or more elaborate than distractors.
- The distractors should be plausible and not obviously wrong at the first glance.
- The key and distractors should all fit grammatically with the stem.
- In comprehension passages, the key should not be obvious from general knowledge.
- To eliminate faults and ambiguity, it is recommended to set the questions as a team.
- Moderation to be done to ensure that:
  - ✓ Marks are fairly distributed.
  - ✓ Questions are well distributed to cover the entire scope expected.
  - ✓ Questions test exactly what the teacher set out to test.
  - ✓ Questions are clearly phrased so that all can understand what is required.
  - ✓ Questions are set in such a way that they do not favour any group of pupils but are fair to all.

b. Achievement tests

They are used to monitor the progress of an instructional programme. It may be formative or summative and is used to determine whether individual learners are ready to move to the next grade .e.g. Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education (KCSE).

Types of Achievement Tests

- Free response – Structured questions, essay questions and filling in gaps.
- Objective tests – True/false items, multiple choice from various options given and marching items.

c. Essay tests

They require learners to express themselves freely by using their own words and sentences.

d. Aptitude tests

They are designed to show whether the learner has the natural ability for doing something or course of education .i.e. it assesses the potential of the learner.

e. Diagnostic tests

They are less formal methods of testing used to identify both problematic areas of teaching or learning and an individual learner's strength and weakness in language.

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f. Proficiency test
It is a summative evaluation that determines how ready a learner is for an instructional programme. Such a test has a cut-off point used to separate those who are ready for an academic programme and those who are not.

g. Cloze tests
They require learners to fill in missing words in a text. They are used to assess the learner's mastery of grammar and vocabulary.

Forms / Kinds of Testing

a. Oral Testing
It is used when testing listening and speaking especially when developing the skills.
b. Written Tests
It used in measuring skills like spellings, comprehension of a text, vocabulary, sentence patterns and continuous writing such as composition writing.
c. Projects
These are assignments given to be done at school or at home for a long period of time .e.g. a fortnight, a month or even a term. They include book review or analysis of set texts.
d. Practical Work
This is where pupils are involved in real activities during language lessons as opposed to ideological and theoretical activities. For example, during the comparative and superlative lessons, pupils may be involved in measuring and comparing different heights of things or other pupils.

Setting and Administering Examination

Guidelines for Setting Examinations in English

a. Scope of coverage – The examination should reflect what was taught during that particular period. It should include both language items (sounds, vocabulary and sentence patterns) and language skills (listening, speaking, reading or writing skills).
b. Vary the question type .e.g. open-ended, multiple choices from various options given, yes-no questions, gap filling, true-false questions, arranging jumbled up sentences etc. However, let the type of question not exceed three in the same examination.
c. Avoid unfamiliar question types and formats to the learner. If unfamiliar format or question type has to be used, the teacher should go through it with the learners before the examination.
d. In written tests, give clear and straightforward instructions, avoid unfamiliar words, and capitalize or underline keywords to capture the learner's attention.
e. Avoid questions where learners are to choose a composition as they can confuse the learners and make marking difficult.
f. After setting, moderation should be done to ensure that:
    - Marks are fairly distributed.
    - Questions are well distributed to cover the entire scope expected.
    - Questions test exactly what the teacher set out to test.

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- Questions are clearly phrased so that all can understand what is required.
- Questions are set in such a way that they do not favour any group of pupils but are fair to all.

Invigilation of Examination

This is the process of watching learners as they take an examination to make sure that they have everything they need and they keep to the rules.

A Guideline to Invigilation of Examination

a. Arrange the examination room properly and remove anything that may distract the pupil's attention.
b. During arrangement, make sure learners cannot access each other's work.
c. The examination room should be well lit and aerated.
d. During real invigilation, be concerned with what is going on in the room by moving around and avoiding reading any other materials in the room.
e. Observe time and inform the learners about it at intervals.
f. Accompany any learner getting out of the room for the call of nature.

Preparing a Marking Scheme

A marking scheme should be prepared as part of the setting process though it can be modified during marking process. The following should be decided on:

a. Number of marks to be allocated to each section, subsection and individual questions.
b. How to deal with answers to different forms of questions like open-ended questions.
c. Procedure and criteria for marking continuous writing.

Methods of Testing Different Language Skills

a. Testing Listening Skills

   Uses of Listening Skills

   To establish whether the learners:

   - Hear physically what is being said.
   - Pay attention to what is being said.
   - Look at the speaker .i.e. eye contact.
   - Wait for their turn to speak .i.e. turn taking in dialogues.
   - Understand what is being said.
   - Respond to what is being said.

   Techniques for Testing Listening Skills

   - Use of minimal pairs to establish whether the learners distinguish various sounds .e.g. seal and zeal, cold and gold, pack and back, hut and hat, bin and bean etc. Read the word or sentences as the learners point at the right ones.
   - Use of pictures or diagrams .i.e. say a word or sentence then ask the pupils identify the picture or diagram describe by the word or sentence.
   - Use of passages and stories .i.e. read a passage or tell a story then ask learners oral questions based on the passages or stories.
   - Giving instructions, requests or directions then pupils respond .e.g. by drawing a simple diagram or picture of the instructions.

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- Dictation .i.e. read a word or sentence as pupils write in their books. However, the teacher should be very fluent .i.e. use correct pronunciation, stress and intonation. Note that this also tests writing skills.

b. Testing Speaking Skills

Uses of Speaking Skills

To establish whether the learners:

- Can speak and be understood by the teacher and other pupils.
- Are able to speak using grammatical sentences and appropriate vocabulary.
- Are able to contribute during group discussions.
- Can use speech to clarify ideas.

Difficulties in Assessing Speaking Skills

- It is difficult to multitask .i.e. the teacher has to deal with individual pupils as others also need to be occupied with work.
- Separating listening and speaking skills is difficult because they are interrelated.
- The teacher may fail in providing the right model .i.e. in terms of pronunciation, stress and intonation.

Techniques for Testing Speaking Skills

- Repeating sentences or words spoken by the teacher putting emphasis on pronunciation, stress and intonation.
- Describing objects, pictures, people, experiences of specific themes and processes.
- Narrating events and experiences or telling and re-telling stories.
- Giving instructions, directions or requests .e.g. directing somebody from Nairobi to Mombasa.
- Participating in conversations, dialogues, discussions or debates.
- Role-play .i.e. the teacher comes up with the context .e.g. a doctor and patient context then asks pupils to role-play.
- Dramatization.
- Recitation of poems.
- Singing songs.
- Telling news.
- Exchanging greetings.

c. Testing Vocabulary

This mainly revolves around on the learner's ability to recall meanings of words in their appropriate context.

Techniques of Testing Vocabulary

- Matching words with pictures.
- Choosing equivalent or words with similar meaning .i.e. synonyms.
- Sentence completion with appropriate word from a given list.
- Cloze test .i.e. completing a short passage by supplying the correct word (s).
- Matching words with definitions.

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- Grouping words according to the main subject .e.g. choose the word that is general in the following: (pen, ink, *stationery*, writing pads, pencils)
- Filling in missing words in sentences.
- Constructing sentences using given words.
- Filling in crossword puzzles.
- Writing the opposite of words .i.e. antonyms.

d. Testing Grammar .i.e. word classes, tenses, singular and plurals.

Techniques of Testing Grammar

- Gap filling exercises .e.g. multiple choice questions like: Fill in the gap below with the correct word. Tom is……than Mary. A. short B. *shorter* C. more short D. as short.
- Paragraph writing .i.e. arranging jumbled up sentences.
- Arranging sentence elements in the correct order.
- Composition writing .e.g. writing texts using given pictures.
- Writing dialogues, letters or describing texts.
- Writing from substitution tables.
- Choosing the best interpretation of a sentence containing a particular structure .e.g. re-write the sentence below without changing its meaning. Tom liked his car although it was old. A. The car was old so Tom liked it. B. The car was old but Tom liked it. C. *Tom liked the car because it was old*. D. Tom liked the car or it was old.
- Matching exercises
- Putting verbs in the correct tense.
- Sentence completion.

e. Testing Reading Skills

This depends with the level of the learners .i.e. whether they are in lower or upper primary .e.g. word recognition and sound-letter relationship tested in lower primary and testing on intensive and extensive comprehensions in upper primary.

Reading Skills that are Tested

- Comprehending reading texts such as short paragraphs or longer passages.
- Understanding the meaning of sentence patterns.
- Distinguishing between letters and identifying letter-sound relationships.
- Recognizing words and associating them with their meanings.

Techniques for Testing Reading Skills

- Cloze test .i.e. completing a short passage by supplying the correct word (s).
- Open-ended and sentence completion questions based on a text or passage.
- True/false questions based on a text or passage.
- Multiple-choice questions based on a text or passage.
- Matching beginnings with the endings of a sentence based on read text or passage.
- Matching questions with the correct answer.
- Matching words with sentences that describe them .e.g. Used to write. A. Cup B. Soap C. Pen D. Stone
- Matching words with numbers or numerals.

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- Matching words, names or sentences with pictures.
- Reciting written poems and rhymes.
- Reading words and sentences.

f. Testing Writing Skills

This is tested depending with the sub-skill to be acquired .i.e.

- Testing Handwriting

  The teacher pays emphasis on letter formation and size, spacing and alignment.

  Techniques for Testing Handwriting
  - ✓ Copying words, sentences and paragraphs in exercise books.
  - ✓ Copying individual letters severally in exercise books.
- Testing Spelling

  Techniques for Testing Spelling
  - ✓ Word completion .i.e. filling in missing letters in a word .e.g. 'b_ _k'
  - ✓ Dictating single words or sentences containing the required words.
  - ✓ Identifying wrongly spelt word in a set of words.
  - ✓ Arranging letters to form words
- Testing Punctuation and Capitalization
  - ✓ Punctuating unpunctuated sentence or paragraph.
  - ✓ Punctuating sentences or paragraphs from dictation.
  - ✓ Capitalizing proper nouns and at sentence initial.
  - ✓ Adding questions tags to statements.
  - ✓ Identifying a correctly punctuated sentence from a list of others.
- Testing Continuous Writing
  - ✓ Writing from brief notes.
  - ✓ Arranging jumbled up sentences in a sequence to form a continuous paragraph or story.
  - ✓ Frame composition (Gap-filling type of composition).
  - ✓ Giving answers to a series of questions which can be used to build up a story or a paragraph.
  - ✓ Writing paragraphs from substitution tables.
  - ✓ Developing topic sentences provided by the teacher.
  - ✓ Pictorial composition
  - ✓ Developing a story from a given beginning or ending.

  Ways of Grading Continuous Writing
  - ✓ Reading it carefully and getting a general impression .e.g. its quality then giving marks accordingly.
  - ✓ Following a marking scheme and giving separate marks for various aspects of writing and adding them up .e.g.
    - ➢ Content – The amount of content and how relevant it is.
    - ➢ Organization of content and format .i.e. grouping ideas, sequence, arrangement in paragraphs, correct format, correctness of sentence structures, vocabulary and punctuation.
    - ➢ Handwriting and general neatness.

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- ✓ Sometimes the teacher can read through the composition and give comments without necessarily grading it.

Using Tests and Examinations Results

Results from tests and examinations should enable the teachers to:

a. Identify any language items or skills that require remedial attention.
b. Evaluate the questions themselves with a view of using them again, modifying them or doing without them altogether.
c. Determine how easy or difficult the question was to assess objective questions .i.e. the teacher counts the number of pupils who obtained each question right and express it in percentage. The percentage of pupils getting a question right is called the **facility value** of the question.
d. Determine the weakness or strength in a multiple choice by counting the number of pupils who choose the key and those who choose distractors then convert to percentages (facility value).
e. Determine recurring difficulties in open-ended questions .e.g.
    - Specific language difficulties like vocabulary, spellings or grammatical errors.
    - Difficulties in interpretation of the questions and instructions.
    - Handwriting difficulties.

READING AND STUDY SKILLS

Importance of Reading

Reading for Education / Learning Reasons / Study Purposes or Didactic Value

People are able to access written information and understand written instructions through reading during learning and examination. They also acquire knowledge through reading. In order to achieve this, one must know how to use the following reference or special reading skills and reading types or methods:

a. **Dictionary skill.**

   Importance of Dictionary Skills

   They help one to:
   - Check the meaning of words and phrases through:
     - ✓ Finding the headword using knowledge of the alphabetical order.
     - ✓ Choosing the meaning which fits the context.
     - ✓ Understanding words formed using the headwords and their part of speech .e.g. kind – kindness, move – movable.
     - ✓ Understanding idiomatic expressions.
   - Check spellings of words
   - Check pronunciation of words
   - Check stress and intonation in words.

b. **Surveying a text**

   Using the publisher's description, content page, index, chapter headings, chapter summaries and captions to gain a general impression of the material, to find out whether it contains useful information and where that information is located.

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c. Skimming

Reading a book or a text rapidly for general information or to obtain the gist .i.e. reading through a text to get an idea of what it is all about .e.g. by looking at table of content, titles or headings, subheadings, sections and subsections, topic sentences of each paragraph, date of publication, photographs, pictures, diagrams and their captions, tables, blurbs and synopsis.

Importance of Skimming

- Helps the reader to decide whether to read the whole text or not.
- Helps the reader to understand the text better if he/she decides to read it as he/she has prior idea of how the text is organized.

d. Scanning

This is reading for specific information in a text or a book.

Uses of Scanning

- To get information from notices, passages, posters, advertisements or timetables
- To find entries in dictionaries, directories or encyclopedia.

e. Critical reading

This is reading carefully for detailed meaning and critical analysis of a text or book .e.g. analysis of set texts. This is meant for interpretation and evaluation of a literary text or a book so as to assess its literary quality and make a judgement about how good or bad it is and whether or not it successfully realizes its intentions. We also look at the values the text advocates for or against and whether or not those values conform or agree with our values or those of our society. For example we look at the plot, setting, themes, character and characterization, language and style in fictional texts. In poetry we look at the tone, mood, attitude, theme, message and styles.

f. Intensive Reading

This is reading for comprehension or to get detailed meaning of a text (passage or short story) .i.e. one reads carefully paying attention to every phrase for understanding.

g. Extensive Reading

This is reading widely and diversely beyond the limits of prescribed course books in learning institutions for pleasure or enjoyment. One can read about politics, religion, health, sports, business etc.

Benefits / Advantages / Importance of Extensive Reading to an Individual

- One improves his / her vocabulary.
- Exposes one to good pieces of writing.
- One learns how to write well in terms of choice of words, styles and organization.
- Broadens one's experience.
- One earns respect when participating in discussions or debates.

Methods of Improving Reading Speed

This can be done through:

- Encouraging extensive reading for enjoyment and relaxation.
- Motivating one to attempt to read faster.

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- Trying to demonstrate some characteristics of a good fast reader .e.g. by avoiding bad reading habits like finger pointing, lip movement, head movement and backtracking.
- Providing practical exercises .e.g. reading in public forums.

Library Science Skills

A library is a collection of books and other reading, study or consultation materials. It can also be defined as a place, building or room set aside for keeping a collection of reading materials. The materials may be in hard copies or soft copies or both. For example compact disks (CDs), DVDs, films, computers, charts, videotapes, diskettes, audio cassettes, pictures and other printed materials. We also have a virtual library .i.e. a collection of full text e-books, journals and databases from various publishers and sources which can be accessed by registered members at any time from any internet connected computer (laptop, desktop or any other portable device). **Library science** is therefore the knowledge and skills concerned with the administration of libraries and what is contained in them.

Types of Libraries

a. Academic libraries .e.g. libraries in universities, tertiary colleges, secondary schools and primary schools.
b. Public libraries .e.g. Kenya National Library, Mcmillan and British Council Libraries.
c. Specialized / Research libraries .e.g. Kenya Medical Research (KEMRI) Library, Kenya Forestry Research (KEFRI) Library, International Livestock Research (ILRI) Library, International Center for Insect Physiology and Ecology (ICIPE) Library.
d. Specialized Government Ministry Libraries .i.e. libraries run by different ministries like ministry of education, health and agricultures.
e. Home / Personal libraries .i.e. private libraries found in homes and offices.

The Primary School Library

Every school should have a library to inculcate extensive reading in learners. It should contain school course books, reference and supplementary materials in print or softcopy or both. If possible, internet services should also be provided. A professional librarian or teacher-librarian that is well versed in library skills, acquisition, policy, classification, cataloguing and systematic organization of resources to facilitate easy access, retrieval and use of materials by pupils and teachers should be available.

Establishing, Developing and Maintaining a School Library

Ways of Establishing a School Library

1. Building from scratch by sourcing for funds through:
   a. Fund-raising.
   b. Constituency Development Funds (CDF).
   c. Soliciting funds from education stakeholders, well-wishers or NGOs.
2. Renovating an existing classroom or any building and turn it into a library.

Procedure for Establishing, Developing and Maintaining a Library

a. Identify the type of library to set up.
b. Get an ideal location or site.

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c. Put up the library .i.e. the building.
d. Build bookshelves and purchase furniture such as tables and chairs.
e. Select reading materials for the library such as printed books, journals, pamphlets, newspapers, CDs, VCDs and computers depending on your ability.
f. Make a written record of the materials either in soft copy or hard copy or both.
g. Organize a library committee and decide on library rules.
h. Devise a borrowing or lending system for the materials and repair damaged materials if any.
i. Classify the library stock e.g. into subject areas then fiction and non-fiction.
j. Organize the books on the shelves as well as the rest of the equipment and stationery
k. Make an accession register to record the books that the library receives. Put a library ownership stamp and place the labels.
l. Make the library catalogues which includes a shelf list, titles, author and subject area.
m. Arrange the books alphabetically on the shelves according to the call numbers.
n. Make shelf guides so that the reader can find books easily and ensure that the lending system is operational.
o. Make the library attractive by putting up posters indicating recent books and subject indexes that are easily visible.
p. Remove damaged and inappropriate stock that cannot be repaired.
q. Ensure that the library is secure.

Sample of Library Rules and Regulations

a. Jackets and sweaters are not allowed in the library.
b. Leave bags and paper bags on the storage shelves outside the library.
c. Observe silence while in the library.
d. Avoid unnecessary movements in the library.
e. No food, chewing gum, ink, paint, or razor blades are allowed in the library.
f. Do not fold, turn carelessly or tear book pages.
g. Pupils are allowed to borrow a maximum of two books for a duration of two weeks while teachers are allowed a maximum of three for a period of three weeks.
h. Leave the books on the table after using them.
i. Do not disturb other library users while leaving the library.

NOTE: A notice of those that are allowed in the library accompanied with opening and closing hours should be pinned on the notice board within the library.

Importance / Functions of a School Library

a. To provide a wide range of teaching / learning materials in diverse formats that can cater for the school curriculum and emerging issues.
b. To develop and cultivate the reading habit and culture in pupils.
c. To assist the pupils develop their reading and study skills and basic methods of inquiry.
d. To provide materials that supplements and support notes given in class by the teacher.
e. To provide interesting and motivating learning materials which can appeal to both the slow and first learners as well as children with special needs.
f. To provide teachers with resource materials required for the instructional programmes and professional growth.

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g. To provide learners with reading materials they would need to read for pleasure or study reasons.
h. To provide user-education and current-awareness services to enable them to know the available learning resources, where they are located on the shelves, how to retrieve and use.
i. To support teaching and any other educational work such as research.

Classification of Information in the Library

Classification is the process of arranging or grouping things of similar characteristics together. Library classification is a system of arranging and grouping library materials (books, print and non-print resource materials) according to their content, format and physical features.

Classification Schemes / Methods of Classifying Information in the Library

1. Dewey Decimal Classification (DDC)
   It was devised by Melvin Dewey in 1876. He arranged and grouped all fields of knowledge into ten main classes where numbers represent subjects .i.e.:
   000 – 099: General Work
   100 – 199: Philosophy and Psychology
   200 – 299: Religion
   300 – 399: Social Sciences
   400 – 499: Language
   500 – 599: Sciences
   600 – 699: Technology
   700 – 799: Art and Recreation
   800 – 899: Literature
   900 – 999: History, Geography and Biography

   Each of these ten classifications above is further subdivided into nine sub-classes .e.g. the social science can be divided into:
   300 Social sciences, sociology and anthropology
   310 Statistics
   320 Political Science
   330 Economics
   340 Law
   350 Public Administration and Military Science
   360 Social Problems and Social Services
   370 Education
   380 Commerce, Communications and Transportation
   390 Customs, Etiquette and Folklore

   Each of these nine sub-classes are subdivided further into nine subdivisions .e.g. education can be subdivided into:
   370 Education
   371 Schools and their activities; special education
   372 Elementary education
   373 Secondary education

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374 Adult education
375 Curricula
376 (Unassigned)
377 (Unassigned)
378 Higher education
379 Public policy issues in education

After the three-figure base, the decimal point is added to split up the notation thesis and create further sub-divisions .e.g. under education will have:
370 Education
370.1 Elementary Education
370.2 Levels of elementary Education etc.

2. Library of Congress Classification Scheme (LCCS)
It began as a special scheme to meet the specific needs of the US Library of Congress. It arranges and groups subjects according to the way the literature tends to be structured. Each main subject is completely separate, with an individual framework and its own index. The main classes and sub-divisions use an alphabetical notation, and further numerical sub-divisions. The main classes are:

A	General Work
B	Philosophy, psychology and religion
C	Auxiliary sciences of history
D	World history & history of Europe, Asia, Africa, Australia, New Zealand etc
E-F	History the Americas
G	Geography, anthropology, recreation
H	Social sciences
J	Political science
K	Law
L	Education
M	Music and books on music
N	Fine Arts
P	Language and Literature
Q	Science
R	Medicine
S	Agriculture
T	Technology
U	Military science
V	Naval science
Z	Bibliography, Library science, Information resources (general)

These classes are further divided into subclasses .e.g. 'L Education' is divided into:

L	Education (General)
LA	History of education
LA	Theory and practice of education
LC	Special aspects of education
LD	Individual institutions – United States
LE	Individual institutions of education – America (except United States)

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LF Individual institutions – Europe
LG Individual institutions – Asia, Africa, Indian Ocean Islands, Australia, New Zealand, Pacific Island
LH College and school magazines and papers
LJ Student fraternities and societies, United States
LT Textbooks

Features of Classification Schemes

a. Subject classes .e.g. Technology
b. Schedules .i.e. a predetermined listing system.
c. Notation .e.g. in DDC, the use of Arabic numerals for main subject classes and decimals for the sub-divisions while in LCCS, the use of alphabetical letters for the main subject and the Arabic numerals for subsequent sub-divisions.
d. Auxiliary tables
e. Index

Classification of non-book materials (NBM)

Non-book materials include CDs, DVDs, audiotapes, slides, globes and maps. The following symbols are used:

AR Art print
CH Charts
EN Engravings
F Films
FS Filmstrips
GL Globes
MA Maps
MO Models
PA Paintings
PF Picture files (post cards, small pictures, press cuttings etc)
PO Posters
PT Phono / Sound tapes
RE Records .e.g. gramophone
SL Slides
OHP Overhead Transparencies

Benefits of Classifying Library Stock

a. It enables the librarian and the library users to access, retrieve and use resource information required in the shortest time possible and with little effort.
b. It makes comprehensive book selection or withdrawal system easy.
c. It facilitates the insertion of books in their relative shelf positions after being lent out or displayed elsewhere.
d. Makes it easy for the library staff to carry out stock-taking in order to determine current stock levels, what has been lent out and books that are lost.
e. Makes it easy to compile statistics .e.g. frequency of use of particular resource materials, the number of books lent to borrowers and books that are in more demand so as to order for more copies

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Methods of Arranging Books on the Shelves

1. Using sequential order based on the conventional classification scheme .e.g. 000 – 999 in the DDC case, or A – Z 999 in LCCS case.
2. Broken order
   This is a mixed arrangement .e.g.:
   a. Putting related broad subjects together like in DDC, 400 (Languages) and 800 (Literature) are put close to each other.
   b. Arranging individual biographies alphabetically using the biographer's surname.
   c. Arranging fictional books alphabetically using the author's surname, title or themes.
   d. Keeping, displaying or storing non-book materials (NBM) in special gadgets then assign expressive media codes or symbols to each resource.
3. Parallel arrangement
   This is where:
   a. Certain books for all the subjects are removed from the main shelves and arranged, displayed or stored in other sections of the library like in the short loan, reference section or special cupboards using conventional classification.
   b. Special collections .e.g. research journals, reports, NBM, materials for creative arts, languages, sciences and humanity are separated.
4. Oversized books
   These are books which may be arranged in special or lower shelves depending on the shelves available .i.e. extra books that are limited in numbers .

Cataloguing of Information in the Library

A catalogue is a list of all the books in the library. We therefore have three catalogue cards which must identify:

a. Certain authors with their books present in the library.
b. Given titles that can be found in the library.
c. Books in the library on certain subjects.

A Sample of Catalogue Cards

a. Author card
   560 Hicks, Johnstone Comprehensive Chemistry and Edition London, Macmillan, 1972. 980 pages
b. Title entry
   560 Comprehensive Chemistry 2nd edition Hicks Johnstone Comprehensive Chemistry
c. Subject card
   560 Chemistry Hicks Johnstone Comprehensive Chemistry 2nd edition

Sourcing and Accessing Information from the Library

a. If you are visiting the library for the first time, ask the librarian at the entrance how to use the catalogue, how to find books on the shelves and where to process the books borrowed. You may also ask for brochures and publications about the library if any.
b. Read the rules and regulations.
c. If you are visiting the library for information, first visit the reference section .i.e. where the reference resources like dictionaries and encyclopedias.

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d. To locate where a particular book is, use the catalogue cards (author card, title card and subject card)

Reading as a source of pleasure / entertainment / enjoyment or relaxation
This may involve reading novels, autobiographies, biographies, newspapers, magazines, general fictional and non-fictional books, short stories, plays, motivational books or articles about different disciplines like politics or religion at free time for adventure and relaxation.

Reading for survival reasons
This may involve the interpretation of traffic lights and public notices.

Reading to understand the world around us
This may involve reading tabloids or daily newspapers to update oneself with current affairs or reading historical materials about past occurrences.

Note Taking
This is the process of jotting down useful information from talks, lectures, discussions or from any form of verbal communication.

A Guideline to Note Taking

a. Pay attention to what you are listening to especially the introductory remarks: it gives the idea of what the main topic is.
b. Write the notes in your own words using abbreviations that are familiar to you where necessary .e.g. USA for United States of America. You may also write incomplete sentences indicated by numbers, bullets or alphabetical letters.
c. Look out for any linking or transitional expressions which mark a shift to another aspect of the topic and thus the need for new heading or sub-heading .e.g. The effects of these are…The first cause is…The last factor is…Another reason is…Furthermore…Moreover…Also…etc.
d. Be keen on significant pauses as they could also signal that an important point is coming up.
e. Write down definitions and main examples.
f. Note when the speaker is rephrasing or summarizing what he has already said so that you don't repeat yourself.
g. Immediately at the end of note taking, revisit the notes to make sure they make sense as you fill in any missing important information.

Note Making
This is the process of identifying and recording main points or ideas from a written work in a list format. It is a way of breaking down a reading passage into small pieces that lists only the essentials. We use numbers, alphabetical letters or bullets while making notes i.e.:
Numbers

1.		1)		i.		I.
2.	OR	2)	OR	ii.	OR	II.
3.		3)		iii.		III.

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Alphabetical Letters

A.		a.		a)
B.	OR	b.	OR	b)
C.		c.		c)

Bullets

✓ –
✓ OR –
✓ –
OR
•
•
•

<u>Steps in Note Making</u>

a. Read the whole text or passage carefully.
b. Identify and underline the main ideas by looking at:
   i. Headings
   ii. Sub-headings
   iii. Paragraphs
   iv. Cues of ideas like use of transitional words or phrases .e.g. secondly, in addition, on the other hand, moreover, however, furthermore etc.
c. Decide on one listing method .i.e. whether numbers, alphabetical letters or bullets which must be used consistently .i.e. do not use more than one listing method in the same note making unless they are sub-points of the main notes.
d. List down the main points in short form .i.e. be brief but as clear as possible. Use summarized language. Use universally known abbreviations where necessary like:
   i. .e.g. – For example
   ii. .i.e. – That is
   iii. etc – So on / et cetera
   iv. U.S.A. – United States of America
   v. U.K. – United Kingdom
   vi. Titles like Mr., Mrs., Prof., Dr. etc.

Example:
Tom moved his head slowly and looked at the tall, slim, beautiful lady; dressed in a red skirt, sitting in the front seat with him. The beautiful lady then reached over, patted and kissed him gently on the cheek then turned to admire the scenery before them. As time elapsed, it started raining heavily until they ran into the building nearby. That marked the end of them sitting there to view and enjoy the colourful scenery.

Question: Make notes on the encounter of Tom with the lady at the scenery.

<u>Notes Made from the Text:</u>

a. Tom looked at the lady next to him.

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b. She patted and kissed him.
c. It started raining and they ran to a nearby building.

Importance of Note Making

a. Helps one to read actively and critically.
b. Makes revision easier.
c. Provides an outline for summary writing.

NOTE:
In note making, it is not mandatory for the sentences to be structurally correct .i.e. it is not a must that the sentences should have the subject, verb and object (they can deviate the rules of grammar) but they should communicate.

Summary Writing

This is the process of identifying and recording main points or ideas about something we have heard or read in prose format .i.e. a short version of what we have heard or read written in prose.

Steps in Summary Writing:

a. Read the whole text or passage carefully.
b. Identify and underline the main ideas by looking at:
   i. Headings
   ii. Sub-headings
   iii. Paragraphs
   iv. Cues of ideas like use of transitional words or phrases .e.g. secondly, in addition, on the other hand, moreover, however, furthermore etc.
c. List down the main points in short form just like in note making in the order they appear in the passage. Be brief, avoiding descriptive words, but be as clear as possible without changing the meaning intended. Use known abbreviations where necessary like:
   i. .e.g. – For example
   ii. .i.e. – That is
   iii. etc – So on / et cetera
   iv. U.S.A. – United States of America
   v. U.K. – United Kingdom
   vi. Titles like Mr., Mrs., Prof., Dr. etc.
d. Sum up the key points omitting examples, illustrations and other details (unless they are crucial to the understanding of the text) in simple sentences in the rough copy.
e. Combine the simple sentences by using conjunctions or transitional words and phrases like: first, secondly, also, as though, because, since, when, after, however, next, moreover etc. then write in continuous prose / continuous form. The sentences must be grammatically correct.
f. Re-read the summary to make sure you do not leave out any main point.
g. Make sure you are within the bounds of the words stipulated in the question. When the question is written as, '**In about**…' you can write **five words more or less** the stipulated limit. However, when the question is written as, '**In not more than**…' you should **never exceed** the stipulated limit.
h. Transfer your work to the fair/final copy.

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NOTE:

a. Unless they are important in the understanding of the text, leave out the following:
   - **i.** Statistics
   - **ii.** Dates and names
   - **iii.** Quotations
   - **iv.** Minor details and comparisons
   - **v.** Examples or illustrations
   - **vi.** Opinions and decorative / descriptive expressions

b. Direct speech is changed into reported speech or statements with the exception of very important quotations.

Example of How to Reduce Words

Main Sentence / Phrase	Summarized Sentence / Phrase
She was very young	She was young
The patient visited his ancestors	The patient died
A crowd of two hundred people gathered	A crowd gathered
They include the following	.e.g.
The car came to a stop	The car stopped
They united in the holy matrimony	They wedded

Example:

Question: In not more than 100 words, summarize the text below.

Stamp Collecting

A stamp is to many people just a slip of paper that takes a letter from one town to another. They are unable to understand why we, stamp collectors, find so much pleasure in collecting them and how we find time in which to indulge in our hobby. To them it seems a waste of time, a waste of effort and a waste of money. But they do not realize that there are many who do buy stamps, many who find the effort worthwhile and many who, if they did not spend their time collecting stamps, would spend it less profitably. We all seek something to do in our leisure hours and what better occupation is there to keep us out of mischief than that of collecting stamps? An album, a packet of hinges, a new supply of stamps and the time passes swiftly and pleasantly.

Stamp collecting has no limits and a collection never has an end. Countries are always printing and issuing new stamps to celebrate coronation, great events, anniversaries and deaths. And the fascination of collecting is trying to obtain the stamps before one's rivals. Every sphere of stamp collecting has its fascination such as receiving letters from distant countries and discovering old stamps in the leaves of dusty old books. A stamp usually has a fascination of its own. Gazing at its little picture we are transported to distant lands. There is history in every stamp. The ancient world, famous politicians, writers, scientists are brought to our minds eye by means of stamps. We see famous incidents too. Stamps so small and minute contain knowledge that is vast and important.

Rough Copy

a. To many people a stamp is a paper used to send letters.

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b. They consider stamp collecting as a waste of time, money and efforts.
c. We have many who buy stamps and find it worthwhile in spending their leisure time profitably.
d. Collecting stamps passes time swiftly and pleasantly.
e. Stamp collecting is limitless.
f. Countries are always printing and issuing new stamps for various functions.
g. Fascination in collecting stamps include:
    i. Collecting stamp before someone else.
    ii. Receiving letters from distant countries and discovering old stamps in old books.
    iii. Stamps themselves: they contain geographical and historical pictures, famous people and incidents.
h. Stamps have vast knowledge

Final Copy

To many people a stamp is a paper used to send letters. They consider stamp collecting as a waste of time, money and efforts. However, we have many who buy stamps and find it worthwhile in spending their leisure time profitably. Collecting stamps passes time swiftly and pleasantly. It is limitless. Countries are always printing and issuing new stamps for various functions. Fascination is in collecting stamps before someone else, receiving letters from distant countries, discovering old stamps in old books and stamps themselves. Stamps also contain geographical and historical pictures, famous people and incidents. Stamps have vast knowledge. (99 words)

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